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Subject: Request for Applications (RFA) Number: RFA-611-13-000003 for The Community-based Forest-management Program in Zambia

Dear Applicant,

The United States Agency for International Development Zambia (USAID/Zambia) intends to award a Cooperative Agreement to support the Community-based Forest-management Program in Zambia. The Authority for the RFA is found in the Foreign Assistance Act of 1961, as amended.

The Recipient will be responsible for ensuring achievement of the program objectives. Please refer to Section I, the Funding Opportunity Description for a complete program description.

Pursuant to 22 CFR 226.81, it is USAID policy not to award profit under assistance instruments. However, all reasonable, allocable, and allowable expenses, both direct and indirect, which are related to the grant program and are in accordance with applicable cost standards (22 CFR 226, OMB Circular A- 122 for non-profit organizations), may be paid under the grant.

Subject to the availability of funds, USAID intends to award an incrementally-funded five (5) year Cooperative Agreement, not to exceed US\$14,000,000. USAID reserves the right to reduce, revise, or increase application budgets in accordance with the needs of the program and the availability of funds. Awards made will be subject to periodic reporting and evaluation requirements and substantial involvement by USAID. Final authority for assistance awards resides with the USAID/Zambia Agreement Officer.

For the purpose of this program, this RFA is being issued and consists of this cover letter and the following:

- I – Funding Opportunity Description
- II – Award Information
- III – Eligibility Information
- IV – Application and Submission Information
- V – Application Review Information

VI – Award and Administration Information

VII – Agency Contacts

VIII – Other information

If you decide to submit an application, it should be received by the closing date and time indicated at the top of this cover letter via email to aaa-solicit-lusaka@usaid.gov. The recipient is requested to submit both technical and cost portions of the application in separate files so they may be reviewed separately.

Questions regarding this RFA must be submitted by e-mail to Mr. John Loongo (jloongo@usaid.gov), **Acquisition & Assistance Specialist** for USAID/Zambia.

Issuance of this RFA does not constitute an award commitment on the part of the Government, nor does it commit the Government to pay for costs incurred in the preparation and submission of an application. In addition, final award cannot be made until funds have been fully appropriated, allocated, and committed through internal USAID procedures. While it is anticipated that these procedures will be successfully completed, the potential applicant is hereby notified of these requirements and conditions for award. Application is submitted at the risk of the applicant; should circumstances prevent award of a Cooperative Agreement, all preparation and submission costs are at the applicant's expense.

Receipt of this RFA must be confirmed by written notification via e-mail to the USAID/Zambia's Agreement Officer identified above. It is the responsibility of the recipient of this RFA document to ensure that it has been received in its entirety.

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Ayana Angulo
Agreement Officer

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ACRONYMS

CFP	Community-based Forest-management Program
CIFOR	Center for International Forestry Research
CO ₂	Carbon Dioxide
EC-LEDS	Enhancing Capacity for Low Emissions Development Strategy
FAO	Food and Agriculture Organization
FTF	Feed the Future Initiative
GCC	Global Climate Change
GMA	Game Management Area
GRZ	Government of the Republic of Zambia
ILUA	Integrated Land Use Assessment
IR	Intermediate Results
JFM	Joint Forest Management
LEDS	Low Emissions Development Strategy
MRV	Measuring, Reporting, and Verification
NGO	Non-Governmental Organization
NJP	National Joint Programme
REDD	Reduce Emissions from Deforestation and Forest Degradation
PFMA	Participatory Forest Management Area
PFMP	Participatory Forest Management Plan
REDD+	REDD and Contribute to Conservation, Sustainable Management of Forests and Enhancement of Forest Carbon Stocks
UN	United Nations
UNDP	UN Development Programme
UNFCCC	UN Framework Convention on Climate Change
USAID	United States Agency for International Development
USFS	United States Forest Service
USG	United States Government

I. FUNDING OPPORTUNITY DESCRIPTION

A.1 Introduction

The Community-based Forest-management Program (CFP) is the flagship piece of USAID/Zambia's Global Climate Change (GCC) project under the Presidential GCC Initiative and designed to exemplify the Government of Zambia's Reducing Emission from Deforestation and Degradation (REDD+) strategy by establishing the largest REDD+ program in Zambia primarily in the Eastern Province and potentially bordering regions, such as Serenje, Mpika, or Chama districts, covering at least 700,000 hectares of forest. Moreover, CFP funds are to enable a development organization or a private entity together to jumpstart a REDD+ program in Zambia by supplying \$14 million over five years with the expectancy that the Recipient and partners will continue operations for decades to come. The CFP will: 1) empower communities to work with governmental and non-governmental entities to lessen the drivers of deforestation, 2) establish and improve joint forest and natural resource participatory forest management plans between communities and traditional leaders, the Zambia Forestry Department, and the Zambian Wildlife Authority to reduce deforestation on customary and reserved lands, 3) promote and enable innovative sustainable livelihoods for forest-dependent communities' alternative to unsustainable timber and charcoal production, 4) implement pay-for-performance and/or revenue-sharing programs based on measuring, reporting, and verification methodologies for forest conservation and carbon sequestration, or other programs that utilize and complement the carbon market, such as social carbon, water, ecosystem, and biodiversity services, 5) provide households with the knowledge, tools, and technologies needed to shift their livelihoods to a more sustainable and profitable low-emissions pathway, and 6) generate awareness, promote action, and continuously engage to dispel misconceptions among local stakeholders and national policymakers on the potential of REDD+ in Zambia and provide empirical data that policymakers can use to develop REDD+ related policies, laws, regulations, and strategies. The CFP will reach forested communities in at least three districts in the Eastern Province and may include Serenje, Mpika, or Chama districts, resulting in improved livelihoods, income generation, and poverty reduction, as well as an increase in the number of hectares under improved management. The exact number of communities and households affected will depend on the applicant's proposal and negotiations with the USAID/Zambia GCC team.

A.2 Background

Zambia has approximately 50 million hectares of forest and a deforestation rate – estimated at 250,000 to 300,000 hectares per year – among the highest deforestation rates in the world (FAO, 2010). The primary drivers of deforestation and forest degradation in Zambia include: charcoal and wood fuel use, timber production, unsustainable agricultural methods, and other land use practices, primarily due to extremely high rural poverty (75-80% in rural Zambia), and their reliance on natural resources for day-to-day survival, combined with the lack of other energy sources in urban areas resulting in high urban demand for charcoal. Each of these drivers of deforestation requires the improvement of quality in communities' assets, livelihoods, and financial / social safety nets to ensure sustainable natural resource management is attainable.

Zambia's large area of intact forest and high deforestation rate constitute a globally important opportunity to mitigate carbon emissions by reducing deforestation. Zambia is a strong candidate

to benefit from REDD+¹, a climate change initiative that seeks to mitigate carbon emissions and enhance development by enabling pay-for-performance programs that compensate governments and local rights-holders for conserving forest carbon stocks. Both the United Nations, through the UN-REDD² program, and the United States Government, through a new GCC program, are supporting REDD readiness in Zambia, including the development of a national REDD+ strategy and preparation for its participation in pay-for-performance programs.

Zambia is one of fourteen developing countries in the world receiving support to its national program through UN-REDD, which aims to prepare countries for future REDD+ implementation. The UN-REDD Programme supports Zambia's National Joint Programme. This three-year, \$4.49 million project was launched in late 2010, and is spearheaded by the UN-REDD Secretariat based in the Forestry Department, headed by the REDD+ National Coordinator.

In order to support the UN-REDD Programme, the CFP will focus its activities at the provincial, district, or community levels to provide model strategies and systems to be incorporated into the national strategy. There is an identified need to demonstrate how REDD+ benefits can be realized at the local level in coordination with government partners and the CFP will supply the guidelines on how to do so.

A.3 United States Government Climate Change Mitigation Programming in Zambia

The United States Government (USG) intends to be a leader on social and environmental safeguards as they relate to REDD+. Based on several strategic documents, including USG Enhancing Capacity for Low Emissions Development Strategies, the Sustainable Landscape pillar of the USAID Climate Change and Development Strategy, USAID/Zambia's Country Development Cooperation Strategy, and USAID/Zambia's Global Climate Change Project: Abating Climate Change by Enabling Sustainable carbon-Sequestration, the United States Government is committed to providing funding to mitigate Zambia's greenhouse gas emissions through a variety of activities.

USAID/Zambia's country-tailored GCC Initiative Project – Abating Climate Change and Enabling Sustainable carbon-Sequestration (ACCESS), will link field-based activities with national efforts to: 1) improve Zambia's capacity to manage natural resources sustainably, in particular, to reduce deforestation and forest degradation; and 2) improve shared benefits of natural resource management between the Government of Zambia and local communities. The Project will build capacity and support approaches necessary to accelerate the country's ability to reduce greenhouse gas emissions.

A.4 Participatory Forest Management Plans

The Community-based Forest-management Program will promote, develop, expand, define, and foster relationships amongst communities, the government, and forest resources within select areas. Participatory Forest Management Plans (PFMPs) will be outputs of the CFP that develop a

¹Reducing emissions from deforestation and forest degradation, and the role of conservation, sustainable management of forests, and enhancement of forest carbon stocks in developing countries.

² *United Nations Collaborative Programme on Reducing Emissions from Deforestation and Forest Degradation in Developing Countries*

framework that the Zambian government and communities can use to achieve outcomes of: 1) jointly setting economic, social, and environmental priorities; 2) jointly regulating the exploitation of natural resources in forest lands; 3) jointly participating in legal and budgeting actions; 4) jointly monitoring, measuring and evaluating the development and utilization of forests and other natural resources within forest lands; and 5) jointly sharing revenues produced from communities' natural resources between communities and the government.³ They are envisioned to be management tools for district level government managers and empower communities to sustainably manage and share benefits from forest resources in targeted areas. PFMPs will guide the management of natural resources in Participatory Forest Management Areas (PFMAs) that are to be located in customary lands, forest reserves, and game management areas. PFMAs are simply designated forest areas where the CFP will be implementing activities and may encompass all, a combination of, or just one public land type (i.e. customary land, forest reserve, game management area, not private lands) within its boundaries. The forest carbon stocks within PFMAs are to be measured, reported, and verified by an accredited organization for generation of revenues from selling carbon credits. PFMAs can also set up systems to complement the carbon market, such as social carbon, water, ecosystem, and biodiversity services. Experience in other countries, namely Tanzania, shows that forests can be well maintained and recover from degradation when PFMPs are facilitated well. Areas of the forest under participatory forest management benefit from: improved water discharge and quality, natural regeneration, reduced fire incidences, reduced encroachment from agricultural lands, and increased game and wildlife numbers and diversity.⁴

Experience gained from the enactment of PFMPs is to be shared with decision-makers and leaders at national, regional and local government levels to review, revise and enact better policies, laws, regulations and administrative rules that support the management and decentralization of forest lands. Current policies do allow benefit-sharing of natural resources between communities and government within Joint Forest Management Areas as well as Game Management Areas, though utilizing these policies and getting adoption and enforcement of such policies will be challenging. As a result, public-private or community-private partnerships are to be encouraged to support benefit-sharing programs.

PFMPs are foreseen to be inclusive, comprehensive, and relevant to several socio-economic sectors, including agriculture and energy, so as not to exclude forest stakeholders and encourage livelihoods in non-timber related sectors that do not contribute as much greenhouse gas emissions as charcoal or timber production do from deforestation. PFMPs should be designed by the Recipient in collaboration with stakeholders and other partners. All forest stakeholders, including women and disadvantaged groups, should be incorporated into the implementation of these plans and value the plans as a useful tool to more effectively and efficiently plan, manage and evaluate resources. This will enable poor and vulnerable households that rely heavily on forest resources to benefit more directly from services provided through PFMPs. Women's roles and contributions to forest management are to be incorporated into PFMPs to acknowledge their

³ Note: Participatory forest management is not synonymous with joint forest management as not all PFMPs will be in forest reserves where JFM designations are given, whereas JFM is a means of legally encouraging participatory forest management.

⁴ Tom Blomley and Hadja Ramadhani, *Going to Scale with Participatory Forest Management: Early Lessons from Tanzania*, 2006.

role in forest management, secure their access to essential forest resources, strive to reduce gender-based violence, and ensure their status as equal beneficiaries of both services and revenues.

Successful community-based PFMPs in Zambia will require significant cooperation and buy-in from traditional leadership and national authorities such as Zambia Forestry Department and Zambia Wildlife Authority. The Forestry Department controls all local and national forest reserves be they inside game management areas, customary land, or set aside whereas the Wildlife Authority only oversees operations within game management areas which may include a forest reserve.⁵ Traditional authorities control land rights, land usage privileges, and the enforcement of traditional laws on customary lands. The type of lands that are chosen will determine which key partners should be involved. PFMPs will only be effective and sustainable once they are recognized, approved, and utilized by institutional structures with authority (both *de jure* and *de facto*).

The boundaries and sizes included with each PFMP should correspond to existing legally defined public land areas as much as possible, including customary land, forest reserve, or game management area boundaries but not necessarily within a PFMA itself. The PFMAs are to be seen as project implementation areas, whereas the PFMPs are living documents to be integrated into community and district governance structures.

The total number of PFMPs will be determined by the Recipient with expected outputs and outcomes.

A.5 Alternative Livelihood Activities

Alternative livelihood activities are simply defined as methods in which individuals can obtain income that does not include any unsustainable environmental practices such as charcoal and timber production and clear-cutting for agricultural or other purposes. The development of alternative livelihoods is critical because deforestation is driven in part by poverty, combined with unsustainable livelihood activities. In Zambia, where the most vulnerable households are those that most depend on resources, it would be difficult to reduce deforestation without addressing household incomes.

A.6 Scope

USAID/Zambia will finance a fast-start REDD+ implementation program for five years committing \$14 million to the pursuit of long-term, mutually beneficial relationships among Zambian communities, local government entities, the Recipient, and other key partners, on forested public and customary lands. The CFP is to catalyze the commencement of a long-term REDD+ program incorporating at least 700,000 hectares of forested lands whereby the Recipient will partner with communities, traditional authorities, government entities, and other key stakeholders to implement pay-for-performance programs utilizing the measuring, reporting, and verification (MRV) process in order for all parties to benefit from generated revenues from the sale of carbon credits and/or other ecosystem services. The Recipient is expected to generate

⁵ Chiefs frequently allocate customary land and rights to cut timber and utilize forest resources using their own authority; however, only ZFD can legally issue permits for timber extraction, charcoal production, and non-timber forest product use, but ZFD requires assistance in monitoring and enforcing the use of forest resources.

income from the CFP whereby the Recipient, with its partners, can self-sustain its activities long after USAID funding through this mechanism has stopped. The CFP will be implemented on forested lands, designated as PFMAAs selected by the Recipient for their REDD+ viability, in Forest Reserves, Game Management Areas, and Customary Lands in primarily the Eastern Province and in trans-boundary forests in select districts of Central and Muchinga Provinces such as Serenje, Mpika, or Chama districts to address the drivers of deforestation and forest degradation and strengthen forest management. Within the PFMAAs selected by the Recipient, sustainable methodologies of participatory forest and natural resource management between the private sector, communities, and the Zambian government will act as examples of long-term natural resource planning that will be used to inform decision-makers within the Zambian government as part of the REDD+ and the Enhancing Capacity for Low Emissions Development Strategies initiatives. Activities should generate short-term, medium-term, and long-term sustainable livelihoods for the participating communities. The MRV process utilized by the Recipient will be linked to national level programs and projects to inform relevant policymakers. The CFP is intended to be used as a replicable and scalable model of sustainable natural resource management that the Zambian government and communities can use to participate in pay-for-performance programs.

A.7 Expected Outcomes

A.7.1 Sub-IR 2.3.1: Livelihoods in Forest-dependent Communities Improved

Result 1.1 – REDD+ viable PFMAAs selected, and their long-term viability legally protected

Expected Results:

- Legal establishment of REDD+ viable PFMAAs as joint forest management areas, community resource boards on game management areas, or other, covering at least 700,000 hectares of forest, in primarily the Eastern Province but Serenje, Mpika, or Chama districts are also allowable. This land can be one large contiguous area (meaning one PFMA), or separated into smaller PFMAAs as long as the following criteria are met, in total:
 1. PFMA land must be located in at least three districts,
 2. PFMA land must be designed to incorporate forested land in game management areas, forest reserves, and customary land, and
 3. PFMA land must include at least three different chiefdoms;
- Improved social and economic attitudes and behavior towards forest conservation and management amongst communities, local government entities, and civil society organizations engaged in PFMA land; and
- Improved knowledge in government entities engaged at the national level in developing Zambia's REDD+ initiative on REDD+ implementation and processes to make it effective and efficient.

Social and Natural Resource Management Assessments:

Social and natural resource management assessments were undertaken in 2012 by the USFS with the Zambia Forestry Department in two areas in the Eastern Province (generally defined

as and/or within the Madzimawe and Nyalugwe Chiefdoms⁶). These assessments will be made available through the USAID/Zambia website for planning purposes as background information.

Result 1.2 – REDD+ PFMPs and their activities developed and implemented

Expected Results:

- Legal establishment of as many PFMPs as necessary to successfully implement this REDD+ program and safeguard communities' rights to manage and derive benefits from their forests for at least 50 years given the expected criteria set out in Result 1.1;
- Improved capacity of communities, civil society organizations, and local government entities, and their members, to implement forest management and conservation plans as laid out in legally approved PFMPs;
- Decrease in rate of deforestation in PFMPs;
- Decrease in volume of unsustainable charcoal and timber production in PFMPs;

Result 1.3 – Alternative livelihood strategies adopted and improved upon for successful REDD+ implementation and longevity

Expected Results:

- Intensified social mobilization amongst communities, local government entities, and civil society organizations engaged in PFMA land to adopt alternative livelihood activities;
- Increased adoption of new technologies, processes, and management practices in alternative livelihood activities for the various subsets of society by gender, age, and socioeconomic class;
- Improved involvement of women, youth, and other vulnerable populations in and expansion and diversification of alternative livelihoods in communities engaged in PFMA land, especially those that reduce gender-based violence;
- Increased partnerships between other USG and donor activities in Eastern Province to improve coordination in forest conservation, forest management, and livelihoods work in PFMA communities; and,
- Improved human capital in impacted areas.

A.7.2 Sub-IR 2.3.2: Joint Management of Natural Resources, Particularly Forests, Improved

Result 2.1: Sustainable, replicable, and scalable models for REDD+ partnerships with communities, government, civil society, and the private sector developed and implemented

Expected Results:

- Increased number of communities participating in joint management of natural resources and pay-for-performance programs;
- PFMA communities set to sustainably manage the operations of forest inventories, i.e. biomass/carbon data collection, through collaboration with traditional authorities, the

⁶ Including specifically the Lutembwe LF, Chamulaza LF, West Patauke GMA, Chilinga FR (proposed), and the

Zambia Forestry Department, the Zambia Wildlife Authority, key stakeholders, and the Recipient;

- Private and citizen-based PFMA stakeholders committed to supporting community-based REDD+ activities either financially, with in-kind labor, or through technical assistance; and,
- Improved stakeholder capacity (local government, private sector, civil society organizations, traditional authority, and community organizations) to implement and sustainably operate REDD+ activities.

Result 2.2: Revenues from carbon credits and other ecosystem services generated and shared with communities in PFMA land

Expected Results:

- Establishment, implementation, and successful propagation of community-based carbon measurement and accounting in PFMA;
- Accreditation of REDD+ generated carbon credits and the implementation of carbon mitigation practices by the Verified Carbon Standard and the Climate, Community, and Biodiversity Alliance;
- Increased value of revenue / benefits generated for communities from joint management of natural resources through pay for performance programs;
- Increased number of communities benefiting from carbon credit payments and/or other ecosystem service payments;
- Strengthened social / financial safety nets within communities benefiting from carbon credit payments;
- PFMA community members receiving at least one payment through the Recipient from the sale of carbon credits and/or other ecosystem payments for at least 700,000 hectares of forest on PFMA land; and
- Community understanding of projected annual value of carbon stocks on carbon markets and estimations on community member income generation for forest conservation activities or other ecosystem services that can be generated.

A.7.3 Sub- IR 2.3.3: Government Capacity to Develop Policies and Plans with Stakeholders for REDD+ and LEDS Strengthened

Result 3.1: REDD+-related strategies, plans, and activities adopted by and supplied to local and national government entities, respectively

Expected Results:

- Improved governmental and/or societal mechanisms for soliciting and channeling citizen input into public forestry dialogue forums and local environmental advocacy coalitions;
- Improved understanding of carbon and ecosystem rights and revenues as generated through REDD+ implementation by engaged government entities at the national, provincial, and local levels;

- Improved government ability to effectively and efficiently process resource rights-agreements as pertaining to REDD+;
- Strengthened framework for social and environmental safeguards in respect to land tenure, resource and property rights, and service accessibility by women, youth, and vulnerable populations;
- Increased number of stakeholders (government as well as private) engaged in the development of policies and/or plans for addressing climate change;
- Increased number of stakeholders (government as well as private) using climate information in their decision making; and
- Increased number of laws, policies, strategies, plans, agreements, or regulations addressing climate change and/or biodiversity conservation officially proposed, adopted or implemented.

A.7.4 Sub-IR 2.3.4: Technologies for Addressing Climate Change Adopted

Result 4.1: Emissions-reducing and/or climate change technologies widely adopted by PFMA communities and stakeholders

Expected Results:

- Increased adoption of sustainable alternative livelihoods and climate smart agriculture;
- Improved emission-reducing technology market linkages between private sector and community organizations; and,
- Adoption of one or more emissions-reducing technologies that contribute to the implementation of a PFMP by a majority of targeted people.

A.8 Program Income

The Recipient is expected to generate income from their activities in PFMAs. This income is envisioned to be revenue generated in collaboration with forest stakeholders and shared between all relevant stakeholders, including the Recipient. This income can be used to meet USAID's cost-share requirements and/or further expand program activities.

Sources of income may come from any activity that promotes the sustainable use of forest resources and encourages improved livelihoods for forest-dependent communities. Examples of envisioned program income include, but are not limited to: sale of carbon credits, eco-tourism, sale of sustainably produced and processed non-timber forest or conservation / climate smart agricultural products that directly complement the REDD+ goals in forested areas, and other programs that utilize and complement the carbon market, such as social carbon, water, ecosystem, and biodiversity services.

A.9 Monitoring and Evaluation

A high quality external performance or impact evaluation is expected for this project, under USAID's new Evaluation Policy. An impact evaluation would potentially include a rigorous evaluation design with a potential counterfactual, and could have implications on site selection and rollout, although all decisions would be discussed and decided on mutually between Mission, the Recipient, and the external evaluator. The external evaluator will develop an evaluation design at the program's outset in collaboration with the mission and implementer. To

improve the practicality and protect the integrity of both the proposed work plan and implementation of the project, as well as the evaluation plan, the Recipient will be asked to:

- review and comment on the draft evaluation plan, survey instruments, and planned collection methods;
- advise USAID and the evaluator on changes in the project that affect the project design, as these potentially affect the evaluation; and,
- revisit the evaluation plan with USAID and the evaluator annually to assure that all parties remain in agreement on the evaluation questions and indicators.

Rigorous monitoring and collection of project-level output and outcome indicators by the Recipient is expected throughout the life of the project to enable performance monitoring, including establishing a baseline and collecting annual data on agreed-upon indicators.

A.10 Gender

In rural parts of Zambia, women rely on forests for carrying out subsistence activities, be they charcoal and timber production or non-timber forest products.^{7,8} Once forested areas are under improved management the tendency for illegal use of forest resources decreases, while the sale of legal forest products increases, impacting lower income households, most of which are female headed households.⁹ Further, the incorporation of women into the management process of forest resources produces health benefits to the forest as well as improved resource access for both men and women, as opposed to management processes that exclude women or men.¹⁰ In fact, “the higher the percentage of women on the executive committee [of a community forest management board], the lower the percentage of degraded forest area.”¹¹

As the study of women in forest management is still new, it is important to know that many of the same gender-biased issues affecting women in other aspects of community life (such as legal rights) also come into play when organizing communities to sustainably manage their natural resources.

A.12 Windows of Opportunity

USAID/Zambia recognizes that improving forest management and forest conservation will be a dynamic effort in Zambia. Although our intention is to address such issues in the Program Description, we are reserving \$210,000 of the total obligated amount to respond to unanticipated opportunities. The recipient will be expected to respond to an opportunity only upon written notification from the Agreement Officer. The illustrative list of opportunities includes, but is not limited to:

⁷ Bwalya, Samuel M. 2004. Rural Livelihoods and Collective Action in Joint Forest Management in Zambia.

⁸ Chabala, Charles. 2004. Forest management in Zambia: A focus on women’s access to forest resources management in Chief Chiwala’s area, Masaiti district. Southern African Regional Centre for Women’s Law, University of Zimbabwe.

⁹ Das, Nimai. 2010. Incidence of forest income on reduction of inequality: Evidence from forest dependent households in milieu of joint forest management. *Ecological Economics*, Volume 69, Issue 8, Pages 1617-1625.

¹⁰ Mwangi, E., R. Meinzen-Dick, and Y. Sun. 2011. Gender and sustainable forest management in East Africa and Latin America. *Ecology and Society* 16(1): 17.

¹¹ Agarwal, Bina. 2009. Gender and forest conservation: The impact of women's participation in community forest governance. *Ecological Economics*, Volume 68, Issue 11, Pages 2785-2799.

- Natural or man-made disasters, such as forest fires or drought;
- Stressors on agriculture linked to environmental changes;
- Ad hoc innovative or creative climate change activities that will be implemented by the Recipient and its partners;
- Advancing the adoption of new technologies, processes, policies, and procedures that reduce anthropogenic stresses on the environment; and,
- Support to local civil society organizations working to reduce the effects of climate change.

A.13 ENVIRONMENTAL COMPLIANCE

The Foreign Assistance Act of 1961, as amended, Section 117 requires that the impact of USAID's activities on the environment be considered and that USAID include environmental sustainability as a central consideration in designing and carrying out its development programs. This mandate is codified in Federal Regulations (22 CFR 216) and in USAID's Automated Directives System (ADS) Parts 201.5.10g and 204 (<http://www.usaid.gov/policy/ads/200/>), which, in part, require that the potential environmental impacts of USAID-financed activities are identified prior to a final decision to proceed and that appropriate environmental safeguards are adopted for all activities.

The applicant's environmental compliance obligations under these regulations and procedures are specified in the following paragraphs of this RFA.

In addition, the recipient must comply with host country environmental regulations unless otherwise directed in writing by USAID. In case of conflict between host country and USAID regulations, the latter shall govern.

No activity funded under this Cooperative Agreement will be implemented unless an environmental threshold determination, as defined by 22 CFR 216, has been reached for that activity, as documented in a Request for Categorical Exclusion (RCE), Initial Environmental Examination (IEE), or Environmental Assessment (EA) duly signed by the Bureau Environmental Officer (BEO). (Hereinafter, such documents are described as "approved Regulation 216 environmental documentation.")

An Initial Environmental Examination (IEE) 611-002 has been approved for the Program funding this RFA. The IEE covers activities expected to be implemented under this cooperative agreement. USAID has determined that a **Negative Determination with conditions** applies to one or more of the proposed activities. This indicates that if these activities are implemented subject to the specified conditions, they are expected to have no significant adverse effect on the environment. The Recipient shall be responsible for implementing all IEE conditions pertaining to activities to be funded under this award.

As part of its initial Work Plan, and all Annual Work Plans thereafter, the recipient, in collaboration with the USAID Agreement Officer Representative and Mission Environmental Officer or Bureau Environmental Officer, as appropriate, shall review all ongoing and planned activities under this Cooperative Agreement to determine if they are within the scope of the approved Regulation 216 environmental documentation.

If the recipient plans any new activities outside the scope of the approved Regulation 216 environmental documentation, it shall prepare an amendment to the documentation for USAID review and approval. No such new activities shall be undertaken prior to receiving written USAID approval of environmental documentation amendments.

Any ongoing activities found to be outside the scope of the approved Regulation 216 environmental documentation shall be halted until an amendment to the documentation is

submitted and written approval is received from USAID.

Because the approved Regulation 216 documentation is an IEE that contains one or more Negative Determinations with conditions the Recipient shall:

- a) Unless the approved Regulation 216 documentation contains a complete environmental mitigation and monitoring plan (EMMP) or a project mitigation and monitoring (M&M) plan, the Recipient shall prepare an EMMP or M&M Plan describing how the Recipient will, in specific terms, implement all IEE and/or EA conditions that apply to proposed project activities within the scope of the award. The EMMP or M&M Plan shall include monitoring the implementation of the conditions and their effectiveness.
- b) Integrate a completed EMMP or M&M Plan into the initial work plan.
- c) Integrate an EMMP or M&M Plan into subsequent Annual Work Plans, making any necessary adjustments to activity implementation in order to minimize adverse impacts to the environment.

A.14 RESPONSIBILITY FOR PERFORMANCE

a) Recipient

The Recipient of this award is responsible for devising, implementing, and continually refining a technical approach for achieving the overall outcomes and objectives specified in the Program Description. The Recipient will articulate its major activities, targets, and deliverables in annual work plans to be discussed with and approved by the AOR. Finally, the Recipient will be responsible for documenting and sharing the results and learning that is expected to come from this activity.

b) USAID

The AOR, based in USAID/Zambia, will be the primary day-to-day liaison between USAID and the recipient of this award. The AOR's primary responsibilities are to ensure compliance with the terms and conditions, to maintain contact (including site visits and liaison) with the Recipient, and to be substantively involved in administration of the cooperative agreement, as described below.

A.15 AUTHORIZING LEGISLATION

The authority for this RFA is found in the Foreign Assistance Act of 1961, as amended, and the resulting award(s) will be administered in accordance with OMB Circulars, 22 CFR 226, and USAID's ADS Chapter 303, "Grants and Cooperative Agreements with Non-Governmental Organizations" as applicable.

Pursuant to 22 CFR §226.81, it is USAID policy not to award profit under assistance instruments. However, all reasonable, allocable, and allowable expenses, both direct and indirect, which are related to this program and are in accordance with applicable cost standards (22 CFR 226, OMB Circular A-122 for non-profit organization, OMB Circular A-21 for universities, and

the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) Part 31 for-profit organizations), may be paid under the cooperative agreement.

A.16 REFERENCES APPLICABLE

Regulations & References

- 22 CFR 226
http://www.access.gpo.gov/nara/cfr/waisidx_02/22cfr226_02.html
- Mandatory Standard Provisions for U.S., Nongovernmental Recipients
<http://www.usaid.gov/pubs/ads/300/303maa.pdf>
- Mandatory Standard Provisions for Non-U.S. Nongovernmental Recipients: <http://www.usaid.gov/policy/ads/300/303mab.pdf>
- OMB Circular A-122
http://www.whitehouse.gov/omb/circulars/a_122/a122.html
- OMB Circular A-110
http://www.whitehouse.gov/omb/circulars/a_110/a110.html
- ADS Series 300 Acquisition and Assistance
<http://www.usaid.gov/pubs/ads/>

[END OF SECTION I]

II. AWARD INFORMATION

A. Estimated Funding

USAID expects to award one (1) Cooperative Agreement based on this RFA. The anticipated total federal funding amount is \$14,000,000 for the Community-based Forest-management Program in Zambia.

The Government may issue an award resulting from this RFA to the responsible applicant if the application conforming to this RFA is responsive to the objectives set forth in this document. The Government may (a) reject the application, and (b) waive informalities and minor irregularities in applications received.

The Government reserves the right to make an award on the basis of initial applications received, without discussions or negotiations. Therefore, each initial application should contain the applicant's best terms from a cost and technical standpoint. The Government reserves the right (but is not under obligation to do so), however, to enter into discussions with the applicant in order to obtain clarifications, additional detail, or to suggest refinements in the program description, budget, or other aspects of an application.

The Agreement Officer is the only individual who may legally commit the Government to the expenditure of public funds. No costs chargeable to the proposed award may be incurred before receipt of either a fully executed cooperative agreement or a specific, written authorization from the Agreement Officer.

B. Performance Period

The anticipated program start date is **November 2013 for a five year period.**

C. Award Type

USAID anticipates the award will be a **Cooperative Agreement**. The intended purpose of Agreement Officer Representative (AOR) involvement during the award is to assist the recipient in achieving the supported objectives.

Substantial Involvement under the award is expected to be as follows:

1. Approval of the recipient's implementation plans. If at the time of award, the program description does not establish a timeline in sufficient detail for the planned achievement of milestones or outputs, USAID may delay approval of the recipient's implementation plan for a later date. USAID will not require approval of implementation plans more often than annually. If the AO has delegated authority to the AOR to approve implementation plans, the AOR should review the agreement's terms and conditions to ensure that he or she does not inadvertently approve a change to them.
2. Review and approval of the selection of key personnel for three positions. The Chief of Party position is a key personnel position. The Recipient must identify two additional key personnel positions that will be subject to the AOR's review and AO approval.

Key Personnel Minimum Qualifications

The Chief of Party must have positive reviews on his/her management of human and financial resources while managing large projects from at least two previous employers and two previous employees, at least a master's degree in a relevant subject area, at least five years of experience working on forestry related programs, at least two years working in sub-Saharan Africa, and at least two years working with developing country governments.

The Recipient should propose minimum qualifications for the other two key personnel.

3. Approval of the recipient's monitoring and evaluation plans.
4. Participation in discussion with Government Officials. USAID reserves the right to participate in any and all discussions between government officials at the national level and the Recipient. USAID further requests that if the Recipient or Recipient's sub-awardee meets with provincial level government officials that abbreviated minutes of each discussion are provided to the AOR. Meetings between the Recipient or Recipient's sub-awardees with district level government officials are exempt from this stipulation and may be met with as needed without informing the AOR.

D. Authorized Geographic Code

The Authorized Geographic Code is 935 for the procurement of goods and services.

E. Branding Strategy And Marking Plan

The successful Recipient will be required to submit a Branding Strategy and Marking Plan to be evaluated and approved by the Agreement Officer in coordination with the Development Outreach Communication Officer and the AOR. The Branding Implementation Strategy and Marking Plan shall be in accordance with USAID Branding and Marking plan as required per ADS 320. Refer to ADS 320, (<http://www.usaid.gov/policy/ads/300/>) specifically 320.3.3.3 for more information.

F. Graphic Standards

The Recipient shall comply with the requirements of the USAID "Graphic Standards Manual" available at <http://www.usaid.gov/branding>, or any successor branding policy. Pending formal Mission guidance, activity with a government entity will be branded, as appropriate, for the program's stabilization goals (USAID Graphic Standards Manual 4.10).

[END OF SECTION II]

III. ELIGIBILITY INFORMATION

1. Eligible Applicants

Any Non-Governmental Organization (NGO) is eligible to apply under this RFA.

2. Cost Sharing or Matching

The Applicant is required to submit a cost-share plan. The percentage of the cost-share depends on the prime Recipient's headquarters location. This cost-share requirement is one way USAID/Zambia is using to ensure a financial commitment of an organization that will be invested in these communities in perpetuity. USAID/Zambia will provide \$14 million to a Recipient for the implementation of this program but requires a Recipient to make contributions that lead to the accomplishment of the expected outcomes laid out in the CFP's program description.

For international, non-African-based organizations, the cost-share percentage is 25%, equating to \$3.5 million.

For regional, African-based organizations, the cost-share percentage is 15%, equating to \$2.1 million.

For local, Zambian organizations, the cost-share percentage is 10%, equating to \$1.4 million.

All cost share contributions must be supported by adequate documentation, be allowable under the applicable cost principles and meet the criteria set forth in 22CFR 226.23.

[END OF SECTION III]

IV. APPLICATION AND SUBMISSION

1. Point of Contact

John Loongo

Acquisition & Assistance Specialist
Embassy of the United States of America
Subdivision 694/Stand 100 Ibex Hill Road
P.O. Box 32481
Lusaka, Zambia
Email: jloongo@usaid.gov
Tel.: 260-211-357000

Ayana Angulo

Agreement Officer
Embassy of the United States of America
Subdivision 694/Stand 100 Ibex Hill Road
P.O. Box 32481
Lusaka, Zambia
Email: aangulo@usaid.gov
Tel.: 260-211-357000

Any questions concerning this RFA must be submitted in writing to John Loongo.

2. Content and Form of Application Submission

ELECTRONIC SUBMISSION OF APPLICATIONS VIA E-MAIL IS REQUIRED.

a. TECHNICAL APPLICATION FORMAT

Technical applications should be specific, complete and presented concisely. The applications should demonstrate the applicant's capabilities and expertise with respect to achieving the goals of this program. Technical applications should take into account requirements of the program and evaluation criteria found in this RFA.

Text must be in a recent Windows-compatible version of MS Word (version 2000 or later) or Adobe Acrobat PDF and comply with the following:

- Typed, single space
- Letter size (not legal size) paper
- Times New Roman or Arial font
- 12 font size
- Charts, tables and spreadsheets may not be less than 10 font

Spreadsheets must be in MS Excel (version 2000 or later).

Application Contents: The technical application shall contain the following sections, as more fully explained below:

1. Table of Contents listing all page numbers and attachments;
2. Technical Approach describing the program's technical approach and expected accomplishments during the period of the proposed Cooperative Agreement.
3. Management Approach describing the organization's business qualifications that are relevant to this award and that emphasizes the management team.
4. Proposed outcomes and impact indicators.

The technical application may not exceed 15 pages in length, excluding the annexes.

Cover Page: a single page with the program title and RFA number, the names of the organizations/institutions involved, and the lead or primary Applicant clearly identified. Any proposed sub-grantees (or implementing partners) should be listed separately. In addition, the Cover Page should provide a contact person for the prime Applicant, including this individual's name (both typed and his/her signature), title or position with the organization/institution, address, telephone and fax numbers and e-mail address. State whether the contact person is the person with authority to contract for the Applicant, and if not, that person should also be listed with contact information.

Proposed Technical Approach: The Technical Application Body will contain the main parts of the technical application and shall address the following sections:

- A technical description of how the REDD+ program will achieve all the expected outcomes, a five year high-level work plan, and a detailed one-year implementation plan.
- A description of activities addressing how poverty will be alleviated in forest-dependent communities and how forest management will be improved in proposed areas with a brief explanation as to why such activities are appropriate in the specified areas of Zambia. Further, a description of how revenues will be generated from the project through means that promote the sustainable management of selected forest resources and how these revenues will be appropriately shared amongst stakeholders.
- A practical and detailed communication, participation, and outreach plan for engaging communities and local and government stakeholders. A contingency / risk mitigation plan for engaging and working with forest-dependent communities.
- A detailed plan for stating the Recipient's intention to stay in communities beyond the lifetime of USAID funding, the methods the Recipient intends to use to generate income for itself over time, and an explanation of various necessary agreements, negotiations, and/or understandings between the Recipient and all stakeholders that will legally define how the Recipient is to generate and share revenues with appropriate stakeholders.

Proposed Management Approach: The Applicants shall submit a management and staffing plan that includes an organogram with projected positions (key and non-key) and reporting relationships. The plan must discuss the division of responsibilities between in-country project staff, home office support (if applicable), and all proposed sub-Recipients. The plan should also include an overview of how activities and communication will be managed and coordinated between all implementing stakeholders.

Annexes:

Annexes are not part of the 15 page limit. The annex order is:

i. Annex I: Curriculum Vitae Of Key Personnel

Applicants shall submit Curriculum Vitae not to exceed three pages in length for three proposed key personnel. Three professional references should be included for each proposed key personnel and USAID reserves the right to interview key personnel if deemed necessary. CVs can be submitted for other proposed project staff members that are considered critical to the success of the project.

ii. Annex II: Implementation Work Plans

The Applicant must submit a draft of the five year implementation plan with high-level activities, timeline, and resources and a first year work plan which displays expected activities per month to achieve the annual performance targets (as specified in the M&E Plan) and results required under each objective. The first year of the implementation plan should be as detailed as possible. The work plan will describe activities to be conducted at a greater level of detail than in the Program Description, but shall be cross-referenced with the applicable sections in the Program Description. All work plan activities must support the Program Description and shall not change the Program Description.

iii. Annex III: Past Performance References and Information

Applicants in the competitive range will be evaluated based on performance of relevant current programs or those completed during the past three years only. For this section, include a concise description of the Applicant's, as well as prospective or existing major partners' previous work and experience relative to the activities and region during the past three years.

For each award, include a brief statement about:

1. The relevance of the Applicant's past development work to the program being proposed;
2. Results achieved; duration, size, and value;
3. List of references and information such as location, award numbers if available, brief description of work performed and contact information with current email addresses and telephone numbers;

iv. Annex IV: Letters of Commitment

Applicants should include copies of any letters of commitment from proposed partners, GRZ entities, and/or other stakeholders. The submitted letters should indicate an intention to pool resources and/or collaborate on the applicant's proposed initiatives. The proposed partnerships should reflect the technical approach described in the application.

v. **Annex V: Environmental Mitigation and Monitoring Plan (EMMP)** – the standard format used by USAID/Zambia's partners is included in this RFA.

vi. **Annex VI: Branding Implementation and Marking Plans** – This is only required for the

apparently successful applicant.

b. COST APPLICATION FORMAT

Submit the Cost Application via a separate email from the technical application. This is due to the strict page limitations for the Technical Application. Certain documents are required to be submitted by an Applicant in order for the Agreement Officer to make a determination of responsibility. However, it is USAID policy not to burden Recipients with undue reporting requirements if that information is readily available through other sources.

The following sections describe the documentation that applicants for Assistance awards must submit to USAID prior to award. While there is no page limit for this portion, applicants are encouraged to be as concise as possible, but still provide the necessary detail to address the following:

- The **SF-424**, Application for Federal Assistance; **SF-424A**, Budget Information – Non-Construction Programs; and **SF-424B**, Assurances – Non-Construction Programs.
- A summary budget in MS Excel with all formulas included ;
- A detailed/itemized budget in MS Excel with all formulas included;
- A budget narrative explaining costs to be incurred which provides in detail the total costs for implementation of the program your organization is proposing;
- Other administrative documentation as required.

The following sections describe the documentation that applicants for assistance awards must submit to USAID prior to award. While there is no page limit for the cost application, Applicants are encouraged to be as concise as possible, but still provide the necessary detail to address the following:

Applicants must provide detailed budget notes or narrative for all costs, and explain how the costs were derived, consistent with the following guidance on required information:

- a. The breakdown of all costs associated with the program according to costs of, if applicable, headquarters, regional and/or country offices;
- b. The breakdown of all costs according to each partner organization involved in the program;
- c. The costs, if any, associated with external, expatriate technical assistance and those associated with local in-country technical assistance;
- d. The breakdown of any financial and in-kind contributions of all organizations involved in implementing the cooperative agreement;
- e. Potential contributions of non-USG or private commercial donors to the cooperative agreement;
- f. Procurement plan for commodities if needed; and

g. Closeout costs: applicants must include in the required projected organizational budget any costs associated with terminating programmatic activities at the conclusion of the cooperative agreement.

Applicants must provide the following cost element details at a minimum and should add additional elements, as applicable and in accordance with the proposed technical approach:

a. Salary and Wages – Applicants must propose direct salaries and wages in accordance with their personnel policies;

b. Fringe Benefits – These benefits are non-wage compensation that an organization can provide to its employees in addition to their salaries. If the Applicant does not have a fringe benefit rate approved, the application should propose a rate and explain how the Applicant determined the rate; in this case, the narrative should include a detailed breakdown comprised of all items of fringe benefits (e.g., unemployment insurance, workers compensation, health and life insurance, retirement, etc.) and the costs of each, expressed in U.S. dollars and as a percentage of salaries;

c. Travel and Transportation – The Applicant should indicate the number of trips, domestic and international, estimated necessary to carry out the proposed program description, and their estimated costs. Applicants must specify the origin and destination for each proposed trip, the duration of travel, and number of individuals who will be traveling.

d. Other Direct Costs – Applicants should detail any other direct costs, including the costs of communications, report preparation, passport issuance, visas, medical exams and inoculations, insurance (other than insurance included in the applicant's fringe benefits), equipment, office rent, etc.;

e. Environmental compliance and mitigation costs;

f. Branding and marking costs;

g. Windows of opportunity (\$210,000)

h. Alliance Opportunities: USAID encourages the creation of alliances where appropriate. An "alliance," in this sense, is a formal agreement between two or more parties created to jointly define and address a development problem. Alliance partners combine resources, risks and rewards in pursuit of common objectives. Alliance partners make financial and/or in-kind contributions to increase the impact and sustainability of development efforts. Their support may take many forms. Mechanisms for collaboration include parallel financing (with common objectives, clear understanding of roles and separate funding tracks) or pooled resources (with agreed upon and legally binding governance structures and common funding tracks).

B. A copy of the latest Negotiated Indirect Cost Rate Agreement if your organization has such an agreement with the US Government;

C. Required certifications, assurances, and other statements. These forms include:

- Assurance of Compliance with Laws and Regulations Governing Nondiscrimination in Federally Assisted Programs
- Certification Regarding Lobbying
- Prohibition on Assistance to Drug Traffickers for Covered Countries
- Certification on Terrorist Financing Certification of Recipient Key Individual and Participant Certifications Narcotics Offence and Drug Trafficking
- Certification Of Compliance With The Standard Provisions Entitled “Condoms” And “Prohibition On The Promotion Or Advocacy Of The Legalization Or Practice Of Prostitution Or Sex Trafficking”
- Survey On Ensuring Equal Opportunity For Applicants
- Applicant Information
- Procurement Information

D. Applicants should submit additional evidence of responsibility they deem necessary for the Agreement Officer to make a determination of responsibility. The information submitted should substantiate that the Recipient:

1. Has adequate financial resources or the ability to obtain such resources as required during the performance of the award.
2. Has the ability to comply with the award conditions, taking into account all existing and currently prospective commitments of the Recipient, nongovernmental and governmental.
3. Has a satisfactory record of performance. Past relevant unsatisfactory performance is ordinarily sufficient to justify a finding of non-responsibility, unless there is clear evidence of subsequent satisfactory performance.
4. Has a satisfactory record of integrity and business ethics; and
5. Is otherwise qualified and eligible to receive a cooperative agreement under applicable laws and regulations (e.g., EEO).

3. Submission Dates and Times

Applications are due to USAID by the date and time indicated on the cover letter.

The full Application (Technical and Cost) shall be submitted using the following method:

1. By Email Submission: the application shall be forwarded to the following e-mail addresses only: jloongo@usaid.gov and oaa-solicit-lusaka@usaid.gov. The applicant is responsible for ensuring that the complete application is received by the deadline. The time of receipt for electronic submission will be based on the automatic electronic delivery time stamp from the usaid.gov e-mail server. **Please do not send files in ZIP format.** Following are the procedures for submission of applications by e-mail:

- a. Before sending your documents to USAID as e-mail attachments, convert them into Microsoft Word, Excel and/or PDF format (for documents requiring signature). Please limit attachments to 2 MB per e-mail.
- b. Once sent, check your own e-mails to confirm that your attachments were indeed sent. If you discover an error in your transmission, re-send the material again and **note in the subject line of the email that it is a "corrected" Submission**. Do not send the same e-mail more than once unless there has been a change, and if so, note that it is a corrected e-mail. Do not wait for USAID to advise you that certain documents intended to be sent were not sent, or that certain documents contained errors in formatting, missing sections, etc. The applicant is responsible for its submission.
- c. To avoid confusion, duplication, and congestion problems with our e-mail system, only one authorized person from your organization should send the e-mail submission.

4. Other Submission Requirements

A. Unnecessarily Elaborate Applications – Unnecessarily elaborate brochures or other presentations beyond those sufficient to present a complete and effective application in response to this RFA are not desired and may be construed as an indication of the applicant's lack of cost consciousness. Elaborate art work, and expensive visual and other presentation aids are neither necessary nor wanted.

B. Proprietary Information – Applicants which include data that they do not want disclosed to the public for any purpose or used by the U.S. Government except for evaluation purposes, should:

1. Mark the title page with the following legend:

"This application includes data that shall not be disclosed outside the U.S. Government and shall not be duplicated, used, or disclosed - in whole or in part - for any purpose other than to evaluate this application. If, however, a cooperative agreement is awarded to this applicant as a result of - or in connection with - the submission of this data, the U.S. Government shall have the right to

duplicate, use, or disclose the data to the extent provided in the resulting agreement. This restriction does not limit the U.S. Government's right to use information contained in this data if it is obtained from another source without restriction. The data subject to this restriction are contained in pages ____; and”

2. Mark each sheet of data it wishes to restrict with the following legend:

"Use or disclosure of data contained on this sheet is subject to the restriction on the title page of this application."

C. Explanation to Prospective Applicants – Any prospective applicant desiring an explanation or interpretation of this RFA must request it in writing. Oral explanations or instructions given before award of a Cooperative Agreement will not be binding.

D. Telegraphic or Faxed Applications – Telegraphic or faxed applications will not be considered.

E. Language – All applications must be in English.

REQUIRED REPRESENTATIONS AND CERTIFICATIONS (ADS 303.3.8)

Assurance of Compliance with Laws and Regulations Governing Non-Discrimination in Federally Assisted Programs

Note: This certification applies to Non-U.S. organizations if any part of the program will be undertaken in the United States.

(a) The recipient hereby assures that no person in the United States will, on the bases set forth below, be excluded from participation in, be denied the benefits of, or be otherwise subjected to discrimination under, any program or activity receiving financial assistance from USAID, and that with respect to the Cooperative Agreement for which application is being made, it will comply with the requirements of:

- (1) Title VI of the Civil Rights Act of 1964 (Pub. L. 88-352, 42 U.S.C. 2000-d), which prohibits discrimination on the basis of race, color or national origin, in programs and activities receiving Federal financial assistance;
- (2) Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973 (29 U.S.C. 794), which prohibits discrimination on the basis of handicap in programs and activities receiving Federal financial assistance;
- (3) The Age Discrimination Act of 1975, as amended (Pub. L. 95-478), which prohibits discrimination based on age in the delivery of services and benefits supported with Federal funds;
- (4) Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972 (20 U.S.C. 1681, et seq.), which prohibits discrimination on the basis of sex in education programs and activities receiving Federal financial assistance (whether or not the programs or activities are offered or sponsored by an educational institution); and

(5) USAID regulations implementing the above nondiscrimination laws set forth in Chapter II of Title 22 of the Code of Federal Regulations.

(b) If the recipient is an institution of higher education, the Assurances given herein extend to admission practices and to all other practices relating to the treatment of students or clients of the institution, or relating to the opportunity to participate in the provision of services or other benefits to such individuals, and must be applicable to the entire institution unless the recipient establishes to the satisfaction of the USAID Administrator that the institution's practices in designated parts or programs of the institution will in no way affect its practices in the program of the institution for which financial assistance is sought, or the beneficiaries of, or participants in, such programs.

2. Certification Regarding Lobbying

The undersigned certifies, to the best of his or her knowledge and belief, that:

(1) No Federal appropriated funds have been paid or will be paid, by or on behalf of the undersigned, to any person for influencing or attempting to influence an officer or employee of any agency, a Member of Congress, an officer or employee of Congress, or an employee of a Member of Congress in connection with the awarding of any Federal contract, the making of any Federal Cooperative Agreement, the making of any Federal loan, the entering into of any cooperative agreement, and the extension, continuation, renewal, amendment or modification of any Federal contract, grant, loan, or cooperative agreement.

(2) If any funds other than Federal appropriated funds have been paid or will be paid to any person for influencing or attempting to influence an officer or employee of any agency, a Member of Congress, an officer or employee of Congress, or an employee of a Member of Congress in connection with this Federal contract, grant, loan, or cooperative agreement, the undersigned must complete and submit Standard Form-LLL, "Disclosure of Lobbying Activities," in accordance with its instructions.

(3) The undersigned must require that the language of this certification be included in the award documents for all subawards at all tiers (including subcontracts, subgrants, and contracts under grants, loans, and cooperative agreements) and that all subrecipients must certify and disclose accordingly.

This certification is a material representation of fact upon which reliance was placed when this transaction was made or entered into. Submission of this certification is a prerequisite for making or entering into this transaction imposed by section 1352, title 31, United States Code. Any person who fails to file the required certification will be subject to a civil penalty of not less than \$10,000 and not more than \$100,000 for each such failure.

Statement for Loan Guarantees and Loan Insurance

"The undersigned states, to the best of his or her knowledge and belief, that: If any funds have been paid or will be paid to any person for influencing or attempting to influence an officer or employee of any agency, a Member of Congress, an officer or employee of Congress, or an employee of a Member of Congress in connection with this commitment providing for the

United States to insure or guarantee a loan, the undersigned must complete and submit Standard Form-LLL, “Disclosure Form to Report Lobbying,” in accordance with its instructions. Submission of this statement is a prerequisite for making or entering into this transaction imposed by section 1352, title 31, U.S. Code. Any person who fails to file the required statement will be subject to a civil penalty of not less than \$10,000 and not more than \$100,000 for each such failure.”

3. Prohibition on Assistance to Drug Traffickers for Covered Countries and Individuals (ADS 206)

USAID reserves the right to terminate this Agreement, to demand a refund or take other appropriate measures if the Grantee is found to have been convicted of a narcotics offense or to have been engaged in drug trafficking as defined in 22 CFR Part 140. The undersigned must review USAID ADS 206 to determine if any certifications are required for Key Individuals or Covered Participants.

If there are COVERED PARTICIPANTS: USAID reserves the right to terminate assistance to or take other appropriate measures with respect to, any participant approved by USAID who is found to have been convicted of a narcotics offense or to have been engaged in drug trafficking as defined in 22 CFR Part 140.

4. Certification Regarding Terrorist Financing, Implementing Executive Order 13224

By signing and submitting this application, the prospective recipient provides the certification set out below:

1. The Recipient, to the best of its current knowledge, did not provide, within the previous ten years, and will take all reasonable steps to ensure that it does not and will not knowingly provide, material support or resources to any individual or entity that commits, attempts to commit, advocates, facilitates, or participates in terrorist acts, or has committed, attempted to commit, facilitated, or participated in terrorist acts, as that term is defined in paragraph 3.
2. The following steps may enable the Recipient to comply with its obligations under paragraph 1:
 - a. Before providing any material support or resources to an individual or entity, the Recipient will verify that the individual or entity does not (i) appear on the master list of **Specially Designated Nationals and Blocked Persons**, which is maintained by the U.S. Treasury’s Office of Foreign Assets Control (OFAC), or (ii) is not included in any supplementary information concerning prohibited individuals or entities that may be provided by USAID to the Recipient.
 - b. Before providing any material support or resources to an individual or entity, the Recipient also will verify that the individual or entity has not been designated by the United Nations Security (UNSC) sanctions committee established under UNSC Resolution 1267 (1999) (the “1267 Committee”) [individuals and entities linked to the Taliban, Usama bin Laden, or the Al-Qaida Organization]. To determine whether there has been a published designation of an

individual or entity by the 1267 Committee, the Recipient should refer to the consolidated list available online at the Committee's Web site: <http://www.un.org/Docs/sc/committees/1267/1267ListEng.htm>.

c. Before providing any material support or resources to an individual or entity, the Recipient will consider all information about that individual or entity of which it is aware and all public information that is reasonably available to it or of which it should be aware.

d. The Recipient also will implement reasonable monitoring and oversight procedures to safeguard against assistance being diverted to support terrorist activity.

3. For purposes of this Certification -

a. "Material support and resources" means currency or monetary instruments or financial securities, financial services, lodging, training, expert advice or assistance, safehouses, false documentation or identification, communications equipment, facilities, weapons, lethal substances, explosives, personnel, transportation, and other physical assets, except medicine or religious materials."

b. "Terrorist act" means -

(i) an act prohibited pursuant to one of the 12 United Nations Conventions and Protocols related to terrorism (see UN terrorism conventions Internet site: <http://untreaty.un.org/English/Terrorism.asp>); or

(ii) an act of premeditated, politically motivated violence perpetrated against noncombatant targets by subnational groups or clandestine agents; or

(iii) any other act intended to cause death or serious bodily injury to a civilian, or to any other person not taking an active part in hostilities in a situation of armed conflict, when the purpose of such act, by its nature or context, is to intimidate a population, or to compel a government or an international organization to do or to abstain from doing any act.

c. "Entity" means a partnership, association, corporation, or other organization, group or subgroup.

d. References in this Certification to the provision of material support and resources must not be deemed to include the furnishing of USAID funds or USAID-financed commodities to the ultimate beneficiaries of USAID assistance, such as recipients of food, medical care, micro-enterprise loans, shelter, etc., unless the Recipient has reason to believe that one or more of these beneficiaries commits, attempts to commit, advocates, facilitates, or participates in terrorist acts, or has committed, attempted to commit, facilitated or participated in terrorist acts.

e. The Recipient's obligations under paragraph 1 are not applicable to the procurement of goods and/or services by the Recipient that are acquired in the ordinary course of business through contract or purchase, e.g., utilities, rents, office supplies, gasoline, etc., unless the Recipient has reason to believe that a vendor or supplier of such goods and services commits,

attempts to commit, advocates, facilitates, or participates in terrorist acts, or has committed, attempted to commit, facilitated or participated in terrorist acts.

This Certification is an express term and condition of any agreement issued as a result of this application, and any violation of it will be grounds for unilateral termination of the agreement by USAID prior to the end of its term.

5. Certification of Recipient

By signing below the recipient provides certifications and assurances for (1) the Assurance of Compliance with Laws and Regulations Governing Non-Discrimination in Federally Assisted Programs, (2) the Certification Regarding Lobbying, (3) the Prohibition on Assistance to Drug Traffickers for Covered Countries and Individuals (ADS 206) and (4) the Certification Regarding Terrorist Financing Implementing Executive Order 13224 above.

These certifications and assurances are given in consideration of and for the purpose of obtaining any and all Federal grants, loans, contracts, property, discounts, or other Federal financial assistance extended after the date hereof to the recipient by the Agency, including installment payments after such date on account of applications for Federal financial assistance which was approved before such date. The recipient recognizes and agrees that such Federal financial assistance will be extended in reliance on the representations and agreements made in these assurances, and that the United States will have the right to seek judicial enforcement of these assurances. These assurances are binding on the recipient, its successors, transferees, and assignees, and the person or persons whose signatures appear below are authorized to sign these assurances on behalf of the recipient.

Request for Application No. _____

Application No. _____

Date of Application _____

Name of Recipient _____

Typed Name and Title _____

Signature _____

Date _____

Part II – Key Individual Certification Narcotics Offenses and Drug Trafficking

I hereby certify that within the last ten years:

1. I have not been convicted of a violation of, or a conspiracy to violate, any law or regulation of the United States or any other country concerning narcotic or psychotropic drugs or other controlled substances.
2. I am not and have not been an illicit trafficker in any such drug or controlled substance.
3. I am not and have not been a knowing assistor, abettor, conspirator, or colluder with others in the illicit trafficking in any such drug or substance.

Signature: _____

Date: _____

Name: _____
Title/Position: _____
Organization: _____
Address: _____

Date of Birth: _____

NOTICE:

1. You are required to sign this Certification under the provisions of 22 CFR Part 140, Prohibition on Assistance to Drug Traffickers. These regulations were issued by the Department of State and require that certain key individuals of organizations must sign this Certification.
2. If you make a false Certification you are subject to U.S. criminal prosecution under 18 U.S.C. 1001.

Part III – Participant Certification Narcotics Offenses and Drug Trafficking

1. I hereby certify that within the last ten years:
 - a. I have not been convicted of a violation of, or a conspiracy to violate, any law or regulation of the United States or any other country concerning narcotic or psychotropic drugs or other controlled substances.
 - b. I am not and have not been an illicit trafficker in any such drug or controlled substance.
 - c. I am not or have not been a knowing assistor, abettor, conspirator, or colluder with others in the illicit trafficking in any such drug or substance.
2. I understand that USAID may terminate my training if it is determined that I engaged in the above conduct during the last ten years or during my USAID training.

Signature: _____
Name: _____
Date: _____
Address: _____

Date of Birth: _____

NOTICE:

1. You are required to sign this Certification under the provisions of 22 CFR Part 140, Prohibition on Assistance to Drug Traffickers. These regulations were issued by the Department of State and require that certain participants must sign this Certification.
2. If you make a false Certification you are subject to U.S. criminal prosecution under 18 U.S.C. 1001.

Part IV – Survey on Ensuring Equal Opportunity for Applicants

Applicability: All Requests for Application (RFAs) must include the attached Survey on Ensuring Equal Opportunity for Applicants as an attachment to the RFA package. Applicants under

unsolicited applications are also to be provided the survey. (While inclusion of the survey by Agreement Officers in RFA packages is required, the applicant's completion of the survey is voluntary, and must not be a requirement of the RFA. The absence of a completed survey in an application may not be a basis upon which the application is determined incomplete or non-responsive. Applicants who volunteer to complete and submit the survey under a competitive or non-competitive action are instructed within the text of the survey to submit it as part of the application process.)

<http://www.usaid.gov/forms/surveyeo.doc>

Part V – Other Statements of Recipient

1. Authorized Individuals

The recipient represents that the following persons are authorized to negotiate on its behalf with the Government and to bind the recipient in connection with this application or grant:

Name Title Telephone No. Facsimile No.

2. Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN)

If the recipient is a U.S. organization, or a foreign organization which has income effectively connected with the conduct of activities in the U.S. or has an office or a place of business or a fiscal paying agent in the U.S., please indicate the recipient's TIN:

TIN: _____

3. Data Universal Numbering System (DUNS) Number

(a) Unless otherwise specified in the solicitation using an applicable exemption, in the space provided at the end of this provision, the recipient should supply the Data Universal Numbering System (DUNS) number applicable to that name and address. Recipients should take care to report the number that identifies the recipient's name and address exactly as stated in the proposal.

(b) The DUNS is a 9-digit number assigned by Dun and Bradstreet Information Services. If the recipient does not have a DUNS number, the recipient should call Dun and Bradstreet directly at 1-800-333-0505. A DUNS number will be provided immediately by telephone at no charge to the recipient. The recipient should be prepared to provide the following information:

- (1) Recipient's name.
- (2) Recipient's address.
- (3) Recipient's telephone number.
- (4) Line of business.
- (5) Chief executive officer/key manager.
- (6) Date the organization was started.
- (7) Number of people employed by the recipient.

(8) Company affiliation.

(c) Recipients located outside the United States may e-mail Dun and Bradstreet at globalinfo@dbisma.com to obtain the location and phone number of the local Dun and Bradstreet Information Services office.

The DUNS system is distinct from the Federal Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN) system.

DUNS: _____

4. Letter of Credit (LOC) Number

If the recipient has an existing Letter of Credit (LOC) with USAID, please indicate the LOC number:

LOC: _____

5. Procurement Information

(a) Applicability. This applies to the procurement of goods and services planned by the recipient (i.e., contracts, purchase orders, etc.) from a supplier of goods or services for the direct use or benefit of the recipient in conducting the program supported by the grant, and not to assistance provided by the recipient (i.e., a subgrant or subagreement) to a subgrantee or subrecipient in support of the subgrantee's or subrecipient's program. Provision by the recipient of the requested information does not, in and of itself, constitute USAID approval.

(b) Amount of Procurement. Please indicate the total estimated dollar amount of goods and services which the recipient plans to purchase under the grant:

\$ _____

(c) Nonexpendable Property. If the recipient plans to purchase nonexpendable equipment which would require the approval of the Agreement Officer, indicate below (using a continuation page, as necessary) the types, quantities of each, and estimated unit costs. Nonexpendable equipment for which the Agreement Officer's approval to purchase is required is any article of nonexpendable tangible personal property charged directly to the grant, having a useful life of more than one year and an acquisition cost of \$5,000 or more per unit.

TYPE/DESCRIPTION (Generic) _____

QUANTITY _____

ESTIMATED UNIT COST _____

(d) Source If the recipient plans to purchase any goods/commodities which are not in accordance with the Standard Provision "USAID Eligibility Rules for Procurement of Commodities and Services," indicate below (using a continuation page, as necessary) the types and quantities of each, estimated unit costs of each, and probable source. "Source" means the country from which a commodity is shipped to the cooperating country or the cooperating country itself if the commodity is located in the cooperating country at the time of purchase. However, where a commodity is shipped from a free port or bonded warehouse in the form in which received, "source" means the country from which the commodity was shipped to the free port or bonded warehouse. Additionally, "available for purchase" includes "offered for sale at the time of

purchase” if the commodity is listed in a vendor’s catalog or other statement of inventory, kept as part of the vendor’s customary business practices and regularly offered for sale, even if the commodities are not physically on the vendors’ shelves or even in the source country at the time of the order. In such cases, the recipient must document that the commodity was listed in the vendor’s catalog or other statement of inventory; that the vendor has a regular and customary business practice of selling the commodity through “just in time” or other similar inventory practices; and the recipient did not engage the vendor to list the commodity in its catalog or other statement of inventory just to fulfill the recipient’s request for the commodity.

TYPE/DESCRIPTION _____
QUANTITY _____
ESTIMATED GOODS _____
PROBABLE GOODS _____
PROBABLE (Generic) _____
UNIT COST _____
SOURCE _____

(e) Restricted Goods. If the recipient plans to purchase any restricted goods, indicate below (using a continuation page, as necessary) the types and quantities of each, estimated unit costs of each, intended use, and probable source. Restricted goods are Agricultural Commodities, Motor Vehicles, Pharmaceuticals, Pesticides, Used Equipment, U.S. Government-Owned Excess Property, and Fertilizer.

TYPE/DESCRIPTION _____
QUANTITY _____
ESTIMATED _____
PROBABLE _____
INTENDED USE (Generic) _____
UNIT COST _____
SOURCE _____

(f) Supplier Nationality. If the recipient plans to purchase any goods or services from suppliers of goods and services whose nationality is not in accordance with the Standard Provision “USAID Eligibility Rules for Procurement of Commodities and Services,” indicate below (using a continuation page, as necessary) the types and quantities of each good or service, estimated costs of each, probable nationality of each non-U.S. supplier of each good or service, and the rationale for purchasing from a non-U.S. supplier.

TYPE/DESCRIPTION _____
QUANTITY _____
ESTIMATED _____
PROBABLE SUPPLIER _____
NATIONALITY _____
RATIONALE (Generic) _____
UNIT COST (Non-US Only) _____
FOR NON-US _____

6. Past Performance References

On a continuation page, please provide past performance information requested in the RFA.

7. Type of Organization

The recipient, by checking the applicable box, represents that -

(a) If the recipient is a U.S. entity, it operates as ☐ a corporation incorporated under the laws of the State of, ☐ an individual, ☐ a partnership, ☐ a nongovernmental nonprofit organization, ☐ a state or local governmental organization, ☐ a private college or university, ☐ a public college or university, ☐ an international organization, or ☐ a joint venture; or

(b) If the recipient is a non-U.S. entity, it operates as ☐ a corporation organized under the laws of _____ (country), ☐ an individual, ☐ a partnership, ☐ a nongovernmental nonprofit organization, ☐ a nongovernmental educational institution, ☐ a governmental organization, ☐ an international organization, or ☐ a joint venture.

8. Estimated Costs of Communications Products

The following are the estimate(s) of the cost of each separate communications product (i.e., any printed material [other than non-color photocopy material], photographic services, or video production services) which is anticipated under the grant. Each estimate must include all the costs associated with preparation and execution of the product. Use a continuation page as necessary.

[END OF SECTION IV]

V. APPLICATION REVIEW INFORMATION

The technical application will be evaluated by a committee comprised of U.S. Government, Zambian Government and Cooperating partner representatives who will make a funding recommendation to the Agreement Officer. The Agreement Officer is the only individual who may legally commit the U.S. Government to the expenditure of public funds.

The criteria presented below have been tailored to the requirements of this particular RFA. Applicants should note that these criteria serve to: (a) identify the significant matters which applicants should address in their applications and (b) set the standard against which all applications will be evaluated.

The technical applications will be evaluated in accordance with the Technical Evaluation Criteria set forth below. Past performance information will only be evaluated for those applicants that advance to the competitive range. The initial evaluation will only consider factors 1 and 2. Thereafter, the cost application will be opened and costs will be evaluated for realism, general reasonableness, allowability, and allocability.

Awards will be made based on the ranking of proposals according to the technical selection criteria identified below. To make an objective evaluation possible, applications must clearly demonstrate how the organization and the application meet these criteria.

Award will be made to responsible applicant whose applications offer the greatest value, cost and other factors considered.

A. TECHNICAL EVALUATION CRITERIA

(a) The factors are listed in relative order of importance. Factor 1 is more important than factor 2 which in turn is more important than factor 3. Within Factor 1, sub-factor 1 is the most important, followed by sub-factor 2 and 4 that are of equal importance, and finally by sub-factor 3.

Factor 1 – Technical, Economic, and Social Feasibility of Implementing and Sustaining a REDD+ Program beyond the Lifetime of USAID Funding in Project Areas

Sub-factor 1 – Methods for empowering communities to participate in and improve joint forest management on proposed forest lands;

Sub-factor 2 – Methods for improving and/or providing sustainable livelihoods to forest-dependent communities and generating and sharing revenues with communities from communities' natural resources;

Sub-factor 3 – Methods for pro-actively communicating the opportunities and challenges of the proposed REDD+ program to proposed communities, traditional authorities, and local government entities;

Sub-factor 4 – Methods the Recipient will use to be engaged in proposed

communities in perpetuity using USAID's funding as fast-start financing;

Factor 2 – Management Approach

Sub-factor 1 - Overall Management and Staffing Plan

Sub-factor 2 - Key Personnel

Factor 3 - Recipient past Performance Information

Sub-factor 1 - Quality of product or service;

Sub-factor 2 - Cost control;

Sub-factor 3- Schedule;

Sub-factor 4 - Business relations;

Sub-factor 5 - Management of key personnel.

Factor 1: Technical, Economic, and Social Feasibility of Implementing and Sustaining a REDD+ Program beyond the Lifetime of USAID Funding in Project Areas

Sub-factor 1: Methods for empowering communities to participate in and improve joint forest management on proposed forest lands.

The technical description must be feasible in scope and accomplish all expected outcomes. The description must include proposed state-of-the-art peer reviewed methodologies or provide innovative approaches for improving joint / participatory management of designated forests and for empowering communities to partake in decision-making roles. Described approaches should take into account the Zambian context, and express a clear understanding of working in the Zambian context on forestry issues. Challenges to implementing a REDD+ program in Zambia must be detailed along with how each challenge is to be addressed and overcome. Changing attitudes and behavior towards the management of forest resources, adopting emission reducing technologies, and how women and other vulnerable populations will be empowered through this program must be emphasized.

Sub-factor 2: Methods for improving and/or providing sustainable livelihoods to forest-dependent communities and generating and sharing revenues with communities from communities' natural resources.

This description must be feasible and contain multiple evidence-based traditional and/or innovative approaches that will be used to engage communities in joint forest management to change their livelihoods to more sustainable income generating methods. This description must include feasible methods for generating and sharing revenues derived from communities' natural resources, be it through carbon credits, ecological services, and/or other derived funds appropriate for the selected areas. The Recipient must sufficiently demonstrate their understanding of voluntary carbon markets and/or other revenue-generating activities. An emphasis on empowering women and vulnerable populations in this description is necessary.

Sub-factor 3: Methods for pro-actively communicating the opportunities and challenges of the proposed REDD+ program to proposed communities, traditional authorities, and local government entities.

A description of a variety of methods, either evidence-based approaches that are traditional and/or innovative, that raises awareness about this project, dispels misunderstandings of pay-for-performance and revenue generating activities to be undertaken, and collaborates with traditional authorities to receive informed consent to operate in proposed communities and forests must be feasible and comprehensive. The description must thoroughly identify the risks to be managed, the challenges to be overcome, and appropriate contingency plans when engaging all relevant stakeholders. This description should incorporate plans to pro-actively engage stakeholders early and continuously during the lifetime of USAID funding. The description must include practical methods for working with local stakeholders (including government) to build their capacity to work effectively with the Recipient to advance the goals of all proposed activities.

Sub-factor 4: Methods the Recipient will use to be engaged in proposed communities in perpetuity using USAID's funding as fast-start financing

This plan for the Recipient to stay in perpetuity in the communities must be feasible, clearly state intentions for the organization's desire to work in selected communities for the long-term, identify methods that will be sought to generate income to pay for the Recipient's continued presence and activities in select areas, and provide a clear understanding of the various agreements, negotiations, and/or understandings the Recipient will have to make with all stakeholders to legally operate in select areas. A plan for generating and sharing revenues / benefits with stakeholders from proposed activities must be concisely described. This description must show proficient understanding of the Zambian context along with envisioned challenges and how they will be overcome.

Factor 2: Management Approach

Sub-factor 1: Overall Management and Staffing Plan

The overall Management and Staffing Plan is logically organized, realistic and responds to the technical requirements of the program. The Plan demonstrates a rational, efficient use of resources and provides for a reporting, implementation, and operational support structure that will facilitate successful achievement of the desired programmatic results. It also maximizes cost-effectiveness by relying on local and/or regional resources to the maximum extent practicable by employing local staff to carry out important management functions, significantly partnering with local and/or regional entities, and/or wholly implementing the program through a local or regional organization.

Sub-factor 1: Key Personnel

The proposed key personnel and other proposed professional staff have the capability, experience, education and other qualifications for the designated work. It includes management, technical, coordination, negotiation, language and other critical skills and abilities. The proposed key personnel should have at least the skill requirements stated in

the Program Description.

Factor 3: Recipient past Performance Information

Sub-factor 1 - Quality of product or service, including consistency in meeting goals and targets;

Sub-factor 2 - Cost control, including forecasting costs as well as accuracy in financial reporting;

Sub-factor 3- Schedule, including the timeliness against the completion of the milestones, delivery schedules, and administrative requirements (e.g. efforts that contribute to or affect the schedule variance);

Sub-factor 4 - Business relations, addressing the history of professional behavior and overall business-like concern for the interests of the customer, including the recipient's history of reasonable and cooperative behavior (to include timely identification of issues in controversy), customer satisfaction, timely award and management of subawards, cooperative attitude in remedying problems, and timely completion of all administrative requirements;

Sub-factor 5 - Management of key personnel, including appropriateness of personnel for the job and prompt and satisfactory changes in personnel when problems with clients were identified.

(a) Performance information will be used for both the responsibility determination and best value decision. USAID may use performance information obtained from other than the sources identified by the applicant/sub grantee. USAID will utilize existing databases of recipient performance information and solicit additional information from the references provided and from other sources if and when the Agreement Officer finds the existing databases to be insufficient for evaluating an applicant's performance.

(b) Applicants will be given an opportunity to respond to adverse past performance information to which the applicant previously has not had an opportunity to respond and the response will be shared with the TEC along with the reference information.

(c) USAID will initially determine the relevance of similar performance information as a predictor of probable performance under the subject requirement. USAID may give more weight to performance information that is considered more relevant and/or more current.

An applicant's performance will not be evaluated favorably or unfavorably when:

- (1) The applicant lacks relevant performance history or
- (2) Information on performance is not available.

When this occurs, an applicant lacking relevant performance history is assigned a "neutral" rating.

Prior to assigning a "neutral" past performance rating, the Agreement officer may take into account a broad range of information related to an applicant's performance.

B. COST EVALUATION CRITERIA

Proposed costs shall be evaluated for cost realism, completeness, reasonableness, allowability, allocability and the competitiveness of the cost share proposed. This analysis is intended to determine the degree to which the costs included in the cost application are fair and reasonable. An overall evaluated price (cost plus cost share) will be determined and will be used as part of the tradeoff analysis in determining source selection.

C. TECHNICAL VERSUS COST CONSIDERATION

For this RFA, the technical evaluation is more important than cost. The applicant will be rated in accordance with the selection criteria identified above. USAID reserves the right to determine the resulting level of funding for the cooperative agreement.

D. REVIEW AND SELECTION PROCESS

Technical applications will be evaluated in accordance with the evaluation criteria set forth above by a Technical Evaluation Committee (TEC) comprised of USAID employees and external technical experts.

The Cost/Business applications will be evaluated by the Agreement Officer on cost effectiveness and cost realism analysis. An award will be made to the responsible applicant whose application offers the greatest value based on the criteria specified above. The final award decision is made, while considering the recommendations of the TEC, by the Agreement Officer.

Authority to obligate the Government: the Agreement Officer is the only individual who may legally commit the U.S. Government to the expenditure of public funds. No costs chargeable to the proposed Agreement may be incurred before receipt of either an Agreement signed by the Agreement Officer or a specific, written authorization from the Agreement Officer.

Anticipated Announcement and Award Dates

USAID/Zambia and its Agreement Officer expect to award this Cooperative Agreement by October 31, 2013, subject to funds availability.

[END OF SECTION V]

VI. AWARD ADMINISTRATION INFORMATION

1. Award Notices

Notice of Award signed by the Agreement Officer is the authorizing document, which shall be transmitted to the individual with the authority to enter agreements on behalf of the Recipient for countersignature to the authorized agent of the successful organization electronically.

2. Deviations

No deviations are currently contemplated to the standard provisions for the cooperative agreement resulting from this RFA.

3. Reporting

The Recipient shall adhere to all reporting requirements listed below. All reports as required under the Substantial Involvement provision shall be submitted by the due date for approval by the USAID Agreement Officer's Representative (AOR) designated by the Agreement Officer. Additional reports requiring review and clearances, when necessary, are listed under each requirement. The Recipient shall consult the AOR on the format and expected content of reports prior to submission.

1. Financial Reporting

In accordance with 22 CFR 226.52, the SF 425 must be submitted on a quarterly basis. The recipient shall submit these forms in the following manner:

- (1) If the Recipient has a Letter of Credit with the US government then, on a quarterly basis, report expenditures/liquidations to DHHS electronically on the Federal Financial Report (FFR/SF-425), lines 10a – 10c and the FFR Attachment (SF-425A) using the [DHHS Payment Management System](#).
- (2) The SF 425 (and SF 425a if necessary) must be submitted via electronic format to the Agreement Officer's Representative (AOR), the Agreement Officer (AO), and the USAID/Zambia Financial Management Office. The Federal Financial Report (FFR/SF-425) is available in PDF or Excel format at the OMB website: http://www.whitehouse.gov/omb/grants_forms/.
- (3) The financial reports are due 30 days after the end of each fiscal year quarter on October 30, January 30, April 30, and July 30.
- (4) If the Recipient has a Letter of Credit with the US government then, a copy of the "Final" Federal Financial Report (FFR/SF-425) report for this award is to be submitted to the USAID LOC Team at locfinalreport@usaid.gov.

2. Performance Monitoring and Reporting

- a. **Mobilization Plan:** Within the first two weeks of notification of the award, the Recipient (with its sub-partners) will prepare and submit a mobilization plan for USAID approval. This plan should describe a schedule for mobilization and staffing the program during the initial three months following award.
- b. **Work Plan:** Within 30 days of signing this Agreement, and annually on October 31 thereafter, the Recipient shall submit an annual work plan and a detailed budget estimate associated with that plan, for USAID approval. This work plan must identify the activities to be carried out and results to be achieved in the coming year, the associated level of effort, and funding sources to be used for that work. The time-frame for annual work plans shall be synchronized with the USG fiscal year, that is, October 1 to September 30. In the first and last years of the program, the partner will develop a partial year work-plan that also reflects the start and end dates of the program.
- c. **Branding and Marking Plan:** The Recipient shall submit a Branding and Marking Plan for the Community-Based Forest management Program to the AOR 45 days after the award date.
- d. **Performance Monitoring Plan:** Within 45 days of the award date, the partner shall submit for USAID approval a performance monitoring plan (PMP) covering the life-of-the program, which includes specific, detailed plans to document, monitor and evaluate program performance. The PMP must establish specific, quantifiable performance indicators and targets for the overall objectives included in the final program description and activities in annual work plans; describe the establishment of monitoring systems to measure program progress against overall objectives; and present a plan for data collection and measurement of overall program outcomes and results, including collection of baseline data, and for the use of data collected by the program to improve program planning and performance. Indicators and data need to be gender-sensitive and sex-disaggregated where appropriate.
- e. **Progress Reporting:** The Recipient shall report quarterly in relation to the annual work plan and the final program description. Progress Reports shall be submitted 30 days after the first three fiscal year quarters to the AOR with a copy to the AO. The reports are due on January 30, April 30, and July 30. The progress report shall include:
 - (1) A comparison of actual accomplishments with the goals and objectives established for the period, the findings of the investigator, or both. Whenever appropriate and the output of programs or projects can be readily quantified, such quantitative data should be related to cost data for computation of unit costs.
 - (2) Reasons why established goals were not met, if appropriate.

(3) Other pertinent information including, when appropriate, analysis and explanation of cost overruns or high unit costs.

(4) Environmental Monitoring and Compliance updates

- f. **Annual Progress Report:** The Recipient shall submit an annual progress report for the previous fiscal year. The results reported should be cumulative from October 1 to September 30 and is due on October 30 to the AOR with a copy to the AO. The fourth Quarter/Annual Performance Report shall follow the same format as the quarterly reports, but additionally shall focus on accomplishments, progress and problems toward achievement of results, performance measures, indicators and benchmarks, tied to the Annual Implementation Plan and the M&E plan targets, for the quarter and the entire previous fiscal year along with success stories. In addition, the Annual Report must include an analysis of the Objective Performance Indicators and any other indicator data as well as a revision of annual target projections for the subsequent two fiscal years. The fourth Quarter/Annual Performance Report must list all publications, evaluations and media products that were sent to the Development Clearinghouse and were submitted to the USAID Development Outreach Communications' Specialist to be uploaded on the USAID website during the fiscal year. In addition, the Annual Performance Report must include qualitative and quantitative data required by USAID for its Portfolio Review and annual Performance Report purposes, including informed perspectives on the program environment impacting the implementation of the Community-Based Forest Management Program for REDD+ Readiness; a brief listing of the project's major activities and successes during the year; and success stories and accompanying digital high-resolution (300 dpi) photos.
- g. **Success Stories:** The Recipient shall submit one to two success stories highlighting project accomplishments to the AO 30 days after the end of each quarter. The Success Stories should be written for an audience that does not have intimate knowledge of the project.
- h. **Environmental Mitigation and Monitoring Plan (EMMP):** The Recipient shall develop the EMMP as part of the annual work planning process describing how the project will implement the conditions in the IEE. This shall include training of Recipient staff and sub-partners, when appropriate; The EMMP shall be submitted to the AOR and Mission Environmental Officer with the initial Annual Work Plan within 30 days of the award date.
- i. **Final Report:** The Recipient shall submit a final report to the AOR with a copy to the AO. The report shall summarize the accomplishments of the cooperative agreement, methods of work used, and recommendations regarding unfinished work and/or program continuation. The final report shall also contain an index of all reports and information products produced under the cooperative agreement. The

report shall be submitted not later than 90 days after the estimated completion date of the cooperative agreement, and include the following information:

- The final fourth Quarter/Annual Performance Report must include a status report on results and sub-results that detail current and end-of-project status. The report must describe progress and process in implementing the activities and institutionalizing reforms. It will include comments on the extent that the program has been successful in addressing its intended outcomes.
- Cumulative achievements and a comparison of actual accomplishments against the goals, objectives, indicators, and targets established for this Agreement, the findings of the Recipient's implementation team, or both. Whenever appropriate and the output of programs or projects can be readily quantified, such quantitative data should be related to cost data for computation of unit costs.
- Reasons why established goals/targets were not met (if applicable), the impact on the program objective(s), and how the impact was/should be addressed; and
- Other pertinent information, including success stories which illustrate the direct positive effects of the program; how unforeseen circumstances affected overall performance compared to original assumptions, how activities were accordingly adjusted or re-targeted; and analysis and explanation of cost overruns or high unit costs.
- **Lessons learned** - Create and disseminate guidelines or protocols derived from lessons-learned and best practices for: 1) legally obtaining rights to manage forests for REDD+ purposes, 2) developing PFMPs with stakeholders, 3) creating partnerships with private sector, civil society, and governmental entities to implement alternative livelihood activities on PFMA land, 4) establishing and maintaining collaborative relations with stakeholders for successful joint management of natural resources, 5) integrating MRV site data into a national database, and 6) encouraging adoption of emissions reducing technologies on PFMA land, in order to replicate and scale up REDD+ initiatives across Zambia.

4. Standard Provisions

For U.S. organizations, the following the *Standard Provisions for U.S. Nongovernmental Recipients* will apply:

MANDATORY STANDARD PROVISIONS FOR U.S. NONGOVERNMENTAL ORGANIZATIONS

- M1. APPLICABILITY OF 22 CFR PART 226 (MAY 2005)
- M2. INELIGIBLE COUNTRIES (MAY 1986)
- M3. NONDISCRIMINATION (JUNE 2012)
- M4. AMENDMENT OF AWARD (JUNE 2012)
- M5. NOTICES (JUNE 2012)
- M6. SUBAGREEMENTS (JUNE 2012)
- M7. OMB APPROVAL UNDER THE PAPERWORK REDUCTION ACT (DECEMBER 2003)

M8. USAID ELIGIBILITY RULES FOR GOODS AND SERVICES (JUNE 2012)
M9. DEBARMENT, SUSPENSION, AND OTHER RESPONSIBILITY MATTERS (JUNE 2012)
M10. DRUG-FREE WORKPLACE (JUNE 2012)
M11. EQUAL PARTICIPATION BY FAITH-BASED ORGANIZATIONS (JUNE 2012)
M12. PREVENTING TERRORIST FINANCING -- IMPLEMENTATION OF E.O. 13224 (JUNE 2012)
M13. MARKING AND PUBLIC COMMUNICATIONS UNDER USAID-FUNDED ASSISTANCE (JUNE 2012)
M14. REGULATIONS GOVERNING EMPLOYEES (AUGUST 1992)
M15. CONVERSION OF UNITED STATES DOLLARS TO LOCAL CURRENCY (NOVEMBER 1985)
M16. USE OF POUCH FACILITIES (AUGUST 1992)
M17. TRAVEL AND INTERNATIONAL AIR TRANSPORTATION (JUNE 2012)
M18. OCEAN SHIPMENT OF GOODS (JUNE 2012)
M19. VOLUNTARY POPULATION PLANNING ACTIVITIES – MANDATORY REQUIREMENTS (MAY 2006)
M20. TRAFFICKING IN PERSONS (JUNE 2012)
M21. SUBMISSIONS TO THE DEVELOPMENT EXPERIENCE CLEARINGHOUSE AND PUBLICATIONS (JUNE 2012)

REQUIRED AS APPLICABLE STANDARD PROVISIONS FOR U.S. NONGOVERNMENTAL ORGANIZATIONS

RAA1. ADVANCE PAYMENT AND REFUNDS (JUNE 2012)
RAA2. REIMBURSEMENT PAYMENT AND REFUNDS (JUNE 2012)
RAA3. INDIRECT COSTS – NEGOTIATED INDIRECT COST RATE AGREEMENT (NICRA) (JUNE 2012)
RAA4. INDIRECT COSTS – CHARGED AS A FIXED AMOUNT (NONPROFIT) (JUNE 2012)
RAA5. CENTRAL CONTRACTOR REGISTRATION AND UNIVERSAL IDENTIFIER (OCTOBER 2010)
RAA6. REPORTING SUBAWARDS AND EXECUTIVE COMPENSATION (OCTOBER 2010)
RAA7. SUBAWARDS (JUNE 2012)
RAA8. TRAVEL AND INTERNATIONAL AIR TRANSPORTATION (JUNE 2012)
RAA10. REPORTING HOST GOVERNMENT TAXES (JUNE 2012)
RAA12. EXCHANGE VISITORS AND PARTICIPANT TRAINING (JUNE 2012)
RAA14. COST SHARE (JUNE 2012)
RAA15. PROGRAM INCOME (JUNE 2012)
RAA16. FOREIGN GOVERNMENT DELEGATIONS TO INTERNATIONAL CONFERENCES (JUNE 2012)

For non-U.S. organizations, the following *Standard Provisions for Non-U.S. Nongovernmental Recipients* will apply:

MANDATORY STANDARD PROVISIONS FOR NON-U.S. NONGOVERNMENTAL ORGANIZATIONS

M1. ALLOWABLE COSTS (JUNE 2012)
M2. ACCOUNTING, AUDIT, AND RECORDS (JUNE 2012)
M3. AMENDMENT OF AWARD AND REVISION OF BUDGET (JUNE 2012)
M4. NOTICES (JUNE 2012)
M5. PROCUREMENT POLICIES (JUNE 2012)
M6. USAID ELIGIBILITY RULES FOR PROCUREMENT OF COMMODITIES AND SERVICES (JUNE 2012)
M7. TITLE TO AND USE OF PROPERTY (JUNE 2012)
M8. SUBMISSIONS TO THE DEVELOPMENT EXPERIENCE CLEARINGHOUSE AND DATA RIGHTS (JUNE 2012)
M9. MARKING AND PUBLIC COMMUNICATIONS UNDER USAID-FUNDED ASSISTANCE (JUNE 2012)
M10. AWARD TERMINATION AND SUSPENSION (JUNE 2012)
M11. RECIPIENT AND EMPLOYEE CONDUCT (JUNE 2012)
M12. DEBARMENT AND SUSPENSION (JUNE 2012)
M13. DISPUTES AND APPEALS (JUNE 2012)

M14. PREVENTING TERRORIST FINANCING (JUNE 2012)
M15. TRAFFICKING IN PERSONS (JUNE 2012)
M16. VOLUNTARY POPULATION PLANNING ACTIVITIES – MANDATORY REQUIREMENTS (MAY 2006)
M17. EQUAL PARTICIPATION BY FAITH-BASED ORGANIZATIONS (JUNE 2012)
M18. NONDISCRIMINATION (JUNE 2012)
M19. USAID DISABILITY POLICY - ASSISTANCE (JUNE 2012)

REQUIRED AS APPLICABLE STANDARD PROVISIONS FOR NON-U.S. NONGOVERNMENTAL ORGANIZATIONS

RAA1. ADVANCE PAYMENT AND REFUNDS (JUNE 2012)
RAA2. REIMBURSEMENT PAYMENT AND REFUNDS (JUNE 2012)
RAA3. INDIRECT COSTS – NEGOTIATED INDIRECT COST RATE AGREEMENT (NICRA) (JUNE 2012)
RAA4. INDIRECT COSTS – CHARGED AS A FIXED AMOUNT (NONPROFIT) (JUNE 2012)
RAA5. CENTRAL CONTRACTOR REGISTRATION AND UNIVERSAL IDENTIFIER (OCTOBER 2010)
RAA6. REPORTING SUBAWARDS AND EXECUTIVE COMPENSATION (OCTOBER 2010)
RAA7. SUBAWARDS (JUNE 2012)
RAA8. TRAVEL AND INTERNATIONAL AIR TRANSPORTATION (JUNE 2012)
RAA9. OCEAN SHIPMENT OF GOODS (JUNE 2012)
RAA10. REPORTING HOST GOVERNMENT TAXES (JUNE 2012)
RAA11. PATENT RIGHTS (JUNE 2012)
RAA12. EXCHANGE VISITORS AND PARTICIPANT TRAINING (JUNE 2012)
RAA14. COST SHARE (JUNE 2012)
RAA15. ROGRAM INCOME (JUNE 2012)

The full text of these provisions may be accessed through the internet as follows:

- Standard Provisions for U.S. Nongovernmental Recipients:
<http://www.usaid.gov/policy/ads/300/303mab.pdf>
- Standard Provisions for Non-U.S. Nongovernmental Recipients:
<http://www.usaid.gov/policy/ads/300/303mab.pdf>

[END OF SECTION VI]

VII. AGENCY CONTACTS

The signing Agreement Officer for this Award is:

Mr. Joseph T. McGee
Supervisory Agreement Officer
USAID/Zambia
Subdivision 694/Stand 100
P O Box 32481
Lusaka 10101
Zambia

E-Mail: jmcgee@usaid.gov

The Agreement Officer who will manage this award is:

Ms. Ayana Angulo
Agreement Officer
USAID/Zambia
Subdivision 694/Stand 100
P O Box 32481
Lusaka 10101
Zambia
E-Mail: aangulo@usaid.gov

The Financial Office for this Award is:

Financial Management Officer
USAID/Zambia
Subdivision 694/Stand 100
P O Box 32481
Lusaka 10101
Zambia

E-Mail: invoice.za@usaid.gov

[END OF SECTION VII]

VIII. OTHER INFORMATION

Issuance of this RFA does not constitute an award commitment on the part of the Government, nor does it commit the Government to pay for costs incurred in the preparation and submission of an application. USAID reserves the right to fund or not fund the application submitted.

1. Special Considerations

The following Standard Provisions are provided below in full text:

BRANDING STRATEGY - ASSISTANCE (June 2012) MARKING UNDER ASSISTANCE INSTRUMENTS (June 2012)

1. Branding Strategy - Assistance (June 2012)

- a. Applicants recommended for an assistance award must submit and negotiate a "Branding Strategy," describing how the program, project, or activity is named and positioned, and how it is promoted and communicated to beneficiaries and host country citizens.
- b. The request for a Branding Strategy, by the Agreement Officer from the applicant, confers no rights to the applicant and constitutes no USAID commitment to an award.
- c. Failure to submit and negotiate a Branding Strategy within the time frame specified by the Agreement Officer will make the applicant ineligible for an award.
- d. The applicant must include all estimated costs associated with branding and marking USAID programs, such as plaques, stickers, banners, press events, materials, and so forth, in the budget portion of the application. These costs are subject to the revision and negotiation with the Agreement Officer and will be incorporated into the Total Estimated Amount of the grant, cooperative agreement or other assistance instrument.
- e. The Branding Strategy must include, at a minimum, all of the following:
 - (1) All estimated costs associated with branding and marking USAID programs, such as plaques, stickers, banners, press events, materials, and so forth.
 - (2) The intended name of the program, project, or activity.
 - (i) USAID prefers to have the "USAID Identity," comprised of the USAID logo and brandmark, with the tagline "from the American people" as found on the USAID Web site at transition.usaid.gov/branding, included as part of the program or project name.
 - (ii) USAID prefers local language translations of the phrase "made possible by (or with) the generous support of the American People" next to the USAID Identity when acknowledging contributions.
 - (iii) It is acceptable to cobrand the title with the USAID Identity and the applicant's identity.

- (iv) If branding in the above manner is inappropriate or not possible, the applicant must explain how USAID's involvement will be showcased during publicity for the program or project.
 - (v) USAID prefers to fund projects that do not have a separate logo or identity that competes with the USAID Identity. If there is a plan to develop a separate logo to consistently identify this program, the applicant must attach a copy of the proposed logos.
- (3) The intended primary and secondary audiences for this project or program, including direct beneficiaries and any special target segments.
- (4) Planned communication or program materials used to explain or market the program to beneficiaries.
- (i) Describe the main program message.
 - (ii) Provide plans for training materials, posters, pamphlets, public service announcement, billboards, Web sites, and so forth, as appropriate.
 - (iii) Provide any plans to announce and promote publicly this program or project to host country citizens, such as media releases, press conferences, public events, and so forth. Applicant must incorporate the USAID Identity and the message, "USAID is from the American People."
 - (iv) Provide any additional ideas to increase awareness that the American people support this project or program.
- (5) Information on any direct involvement from host-country government or ministry, including any planned acknowledgement of the host-country government.
- (6) Any other groups whose logo or identity the applicant will use on program materials and related materials. Indicate if they are a donor or why they will be visibly acknowledged, and if they will receive the same prominence as USAID.
- e. The Agreement Officer will consider the Branding Strategy's adequacy in the award criteria. The Branding Strategy will be reviewed to ensure the above information is adequately included and consistent with the stated objectives of the award, the applicant's cost data submissions, and the performance plan.
- f. If the applicant receives an assistance award, the Branding Strategy will be included in and made part of the resulting grant or cooperative agreement

(END OF PROVISION)

2. Marking Plan – Assistance (June 2012)

a. Applicants recommended for an assistance award must submit and negotiate a “Marking Plan,” detailing the public communications, commodities, and program materials, and other items that will visibly bear the “USAID Identity,” which comprises of the USAID logo and brandmark, with the tagline “from the American people.” The USAID Identity is the official marking for the Agency, and is found on the USAID Web site at <http://transition.usaid.gov/branding>.

b. The request for a Marking Plan, by the Agreement Officer from the applicant, confers no rights to the applicant and constitutes no USAID commitment to an award.

c. Failure to submit and negotiate a Marking Plan within the time frame specified by the Agreement Officer will make the applicant ineligible for an award.

d. The applicant must include all estimated costs associated with branding and marking USAID programs, such as plaques, stickers, banners, press events, materials, and so forth, in the budget portion of the application. These costs are subject to the revision and negotiation with the Agreement Officer and will be incorporated into the Total Estimated Amount of the grant, cooperative agreement or other assistance instrument.

e. The Marking Plan must include all of the following:

(1) A description of the public communications, commodities, and program materials that the applicant plans to produce and which will bear the USAID Identity as part of the award, including:

(i) Program, project, or activity sites funded by USAID, including visible infrastructure projects or other sites physical in nature;

(ii) Technical assistance, studies, reports, papers, publications, audio-visual productions, public service announcements, Web sites/Internet activities, promotional, informational, media, or communications products funded by USAID;

(iii) Commodities, equipment, supplies, and other materials funded by USAID, including commodities or equipment provided under humanitarian assistance or disaster relief programs; and

(iv) It is acceptable to cobrand the title with the USAID Identity and the applicant's identity.

(v) Events financed by USAID, such as training courses, conferences, seminars, exhibitions, fairs, workshops, press conferences and other public activities. If the USAID Identity cannot be displayed, the recipient is encouraged to otherwise acknowledge USAID and the support of the American people.

(2) A table on the program deliverables with the following details:

(i) The program deliverables that the applicant plans to mark with the USAID Identity;

- (ii) The type of marking and what materials the applicant will use to mark the program deliverables;
 - (iii) When in the performance period the applicant will mark the program deliverables, and where the applicant will place the marking;
 - (iv) What program deliverables the applicant does not plan to mark with the USAID Identity, and
 - (v) The rationale for not marking program deliverables.
- (3) Any requests for an exemption from USAID marking requirements, and an explanation of why the exemption would apply. The applicant may request an exemption if USAID marking requirements would:
- (i) Compromise the intrinsic independence or neutrality of a program or materials where independence or neutrality is an inherent aspect of the program and materials. The applicant must identify the USAID Strategic Objective, Interim Result, or program goal furthered by an appearance of neutrality, or state why an aspect of the award is presumptively neutral. Identify by category or deliverable item, examples of material for which an exemption is sought.
 - (ii) Diminish the credibility of audits, reports, analyses, studies, or policy recommendations whose data or findings must be seen as independent. The applicant must explain why each particular deliverable must be seen as credible.
 - (iii) Undercut host-country government “ownership” of constitutions, laws, regulations, policies, studies, assessments, reports, publications, surveys or audits, public service announcements, or other communications. The applicant must explain why each particular item or product is better positioned as host-country government item or product.
 - (iv) Impair the functionality of an item. The applicant must explain how marking the item or commodity would impair its functionality.
 - (v) Incur substantial costs or be impractical. The applicant must explain why marking would not be cost beneficial or practical.
 - (vi) Offend local cultural or social norms, or be considered inappropriate. The applicant must identify the relevant norm, and explain why marking would violate that norm or otherwise be inappropriate.
 - (vii) Conflict with international law. The applicant must identify the applicable international law violated by the marking.

- f. The Agreement Officer will consider the Marking Plan's adequacy and reasonableness in the award criteria, and will approve and disapprove any exemption requests. The Marking Plan will be reviewed to ensure the above information is adequately included and consistent with the stated objectives of the award, the applicant's cost data submissions, and the performance plan.
- g. If the applicant receives an assistance award, the Marking Plan, including any approved exemptions, will be included in and made part of the resulting grant or cooperative agreement, and will apply for the term of the award unless provided otherwise.

Definitions

- Forest: Defined by the UN-Food and Agriculture Organization as land areas with a minimum area of 0.5 hectares, a canopy cover of at least 10%, and a minimum tree height of 5 meters.
- Replicability: The likelihood of a program or activity to retain its effectiveness and efficiency in various operating environments, for the CFP's purposes this entails different chiefdoms, different landscapes, and different cultures.
- Scalability: The likelihood of a program or activity to retain its effectiveness and efficiency at various scales, either larger or narrower in scope, of implementation under similar conditions as the original program or activity.
- Vulnerable Populations: Groups or individuals that include the disabled, elderly, widows/widowers, non-adult male headed households, and the geographically isolated.

Reference Documents

- Chundama, M. 2009. *Preparing for REDD in dryland forests: Investigating the options and potential synergy for REDD payment in the miombo eco-region, Zambia country study*. London: International Institute for Environment and Development. <http://www.profor.info/profor/sites/profor.info/files/Preparing%20for%20REDD%20%28Zambia%20Country%20Study%20%29%20FINAL.doc>
- Bond, I., M. Chambwera, B. Jones, I. Nhantumbo, and M. Chundama. 2010. *REDD+ in dryland forests: issues and prospects for pro-poor REDD in the miombo woodlands of southern Africa*. IIED Natural Resource Issues no. 21 <http://www.iied.org/pubs/pdfs/17506IIED.pdf>
- Eckman, K. 2007. *Gender Mainstreaming in Forestry in Africa: Zambia*. Rome: Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations.
- Government of the Republic of Zambia and Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations. 2008. *Integrated Land Use Assessment (ILUA) Zambia 2005-2008*. <http://www.fao.org/forestry/15461-1-20.pdf>
- Government of the Republic of Zambia, Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations, United Nations Development Programme, and United Nations Environment Programme. August 2010. *UN Collaborative Programme on Reducing Emissions from Deforestation and Forest Degradation in Developing Countries National Joint Programme Document*. http://www.unredd.net/index.php?option=com_docman&task=doc_download&gid=3157
- Government of the Republic of Zambia and Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations. 2010. *Integrated Land Use Assessment Project (ILUA) II, Zambia Project Plan*. http://foris.fao.org/static/pdf/nfma/ILUA_II_PD_public.pdf
- United States Government. October 2010. Strategic Choices for United States Fast Start Financing for REDD+. http://www.usaid.gov/our_work/environment/climate/docs/UnitedStatesREDD+Strategy.pdf
- U.S. Agency for International Development. January 2012. *USAID Climate Change and Development Strategy, 2012-2016*. Washington, D.C.: USAID. http://www.usaid.gov/our_work/policy_planning_and_learning/documents/GCCS.pdf
- Whiteman, A. 2001. *An Appraisal of the Licensing and Forest Revenue System in Zambia*. <http://www.fao.org/docrep/003/X6824E/X6824E00.htm#TOC>.

**Key USAID and USFS activity design analyses are provided with the solicitation as attachments/annexes

Survey on Ensuring Equal Opportunity for Applicants

OMB No. 1890-0014 Exp. 1/31/2006

Purpose: The Federal government is committed to ensuring that all qualified applicants, small or large, non-religious or faith-based, have an equal opportunity to compete for Federal funding. In order for us to better understand the population of applicants for Federal funds, we are asking nonprofit private organizations (not including private universities) to fill out this survey.

Upon receipt, the survey will be separated from the application. Information provided on the survey will not be considered in any way in making funding decisions and will not be included in the Federal grants database. While your help in this data collection process is greatly appreciated, completion of this survey is voluntary.

Instructions for Submitting the Survey: If you are applying using a hard copy application, please place the completed survey in an envelope labeled "Applicant Survey." Seal the envelope and include it along with your application package. If you are applying electronically, please submit this survey along with your application.

Applicant's (Organization) Name: _____

Applicant's DUNS Number: _____

Grant Name: _____ CFDA Number: _____

1. Does the applicant have 501(c)(3) status?

☐ Yes

☐ No

2. How many full-time equivalent employees does the applicant have? (Check only one box).

☐ 3 or Fewer

☐ 15-50

☐ 4-5

☐ 51-100

☐ 6-14

☐ over 100

3. What is the size of the applicant's annual budget?
(Check only one box.)

☐ Less Than \$150,000

☐ \$150,000 - \$299,999

☐ \$300,000 - \$499,999

☐ \$500,000 - \$999,999

☐ \$1,000,000 - \$4,999,999

☐ \$5,000,000 or more

4. Is the applicant a faith-based/religious organization?

☐ Yes

☐ No

5. Is the applicant a non-religious community-based organization?

☐ Yes

☐ No

6. Is the applicant an intermediary that will manage the grant on behalf of other organizations?

☐ Yes

☐ No

7. Has the applicant ever received a government grant or contract (Federal, State, or local)?

☐ Yes

☐ No

8. Is the applicant a local affiliate of a national organization?

☐ Yes

☐ No

Survey Instructions on Ensuring Equal Opportunity for Applicants

Provide the applicant's (organization) name and DUNS number and the grant name and CFDA number.

1. 501(c)(3) status is a legal designation provided on application to the Internal Revenue Service by eligible organizations. Some grant programs may require nonprofit applicants to have 501(c)(3) status. Other grant programs do not.
2. For example, two part-time employees who each work half-time equal one full-time equivalent employee. If the applicant is a local affiliate of a national organization, the responses to survey questions 2 and 3 should reflect the staff and budget size of the local affiliate.
3. Annual budget means the amount of money your organization spends each year on all of its activities.
4. Self-identify.
5. An organization is considered a community-based organization if its headquarters/service location shares the same zip code as the clients you serve.
6. An "intermediary" is an organization that enables a group of small organizations to receive and manage government funds by administering the grant on their behalf.
7. Self-explanatory.
8. Self-explanatory.

According to the Paperwork Reduction Act of 1995, no persons are required to respond to a collection of information unless such collection displays a valid OMB control number. The valid OMB control number for this information collection is 1890-0014. The time required to complete this information collection is estimated to average five (5) minutes per response, including the time to review instructions, search existing data resources, gather the data needed, and complete and review the information collection. **If you have any comments concerning the accuracy of the time estimate(s) or suggestions for improving this form, please write to: U.S. Department of Education, Washington, D.C. 2202-4651.**

If you have comments or concerns regarding the status of your individual submission of this form, write directly to the USAID Agreement Officer.

OMB No. 1890-0014 Exp. 1/31/2006

Paperwork Burden Statement

[END OF SECTION VIII]

Environmental Mitigation and Monitoring Plan (EMMP)

An EMMP should either be included in or developed for (1) **all IEEs** that have at least one “Negative Determination with Conditions” and (2) all Environmental Assessments (EAs).

If the EMMP is not developed as part of the IEE, the implementing partner should usually lead development of the EMMP, subject to review and oversight by the MEO and CTO.

In all cases, the tasks identified in the EMMP are incorporated into the implementing partner’s Work Plan, budget, and reporting.

The following EMMP format is recommended. It can be adapted, as necessary.

Environmental Mitigation and Monitoring Plan

Activity Title:

Implementing Partner:

Activity	Mitigation measure(s)	Monitoring indicator(s)	Monitoring and Reporting Frequency	Party(ies) responsible.
List all activities in IEE that received a “negative determination with conditions.” <i>Do not list any other activities.</i>	If mitigation measures are well-specified in the IEE, quote directly from IEE If they are not well-specified in the IEE, define more specifically here.	Specify indicators to (1) determine if mitigation is in place and (2) successful. For example, visual inspections for seepage around pit latrine; sedimentation at stream crossings, etc.)	For example: “monitor weekly, and report in quarterly reports. If XXX occurs, immediately inform USAID activity manager.”	If appropriate, <i>separately</i> specify the parties responsible for mitigation, for monitoring and for reporting.